HCC-TEMPS
TEMPING MADE EASY

Staff Guide

The Staff portal, the WordPress dashboard and what to do when something goes wrong.

For HCC-Temps compliance staff, managers and administrators · Desktop · Version 2.3 · October 2026

Contents

1. How the system fits together
2. Logging in to the Staff portal
3. The dashboard
4. A candidate's folder
5. Reviewing documents
6. The update email to the candidate
7. Mark complete (override)
8. Checks, references and declaration
9. Notes and the activity log
10. Messages from candidates
11. Training reminders and the e-learning portal
12. Changing a candidate's email
13. Finishing onboarding, or closing
14. Viewing and downloading files
15. Adding staff to the Staff portal
16. The WordPress dashboard
17. Job Board: add, change, close
18. Importing jobs from a spreadsheet
19. Deleting a candidate
20. Admin access and login codes
21. Website settings (Customize)
22. Team members on About us
23. Blog posts
24. Automatic emails and reminders
25. Troubleshooting

START HERE

How the system fits together

There are two places to work. Most day-to-day work happens in the **Staff portal**. The **WordPress dashboard** is for the website itself: jobs, settings and user accounts.

Where	What you do there	Address
Staff portal	Review candidates and documents, send updates, record checks and references, sign candidates off, download files, add staff.	`hcctemps.co.uk/staff`
WordPress dashboard	Job adverts, importing jobs, deleting candidate records, website settings, About us team, user accounts.	`hcctemps.co.uk/wp-admin`
Candidate portal	What candidates see: their answers, documents, training and your updates. You can open it read-only with **View as candidate**.	`hcctemps.co.uk/my-application`

The life of a registration

1. The candidate creates an account and confirms their email with a 6-digit code.
2. They answer the pre-screening questions, then upload documents and training certificates. Anything they don't have yet can be marked "I don't have this yet".
3. When they submit, the staffing inbox gets a full summary with their CV attached.
4. You review in the Staff portal: approve, ask for replacements, request missing items, record checks and references.
5. Your changes collect in an **Update** tray and go to the candidate in one email when you press Send.
6. When everything is complete you press **Finish onboarding**. The candidate moves to **Staff completed** and gets a "ready to work" email.

Who can do what

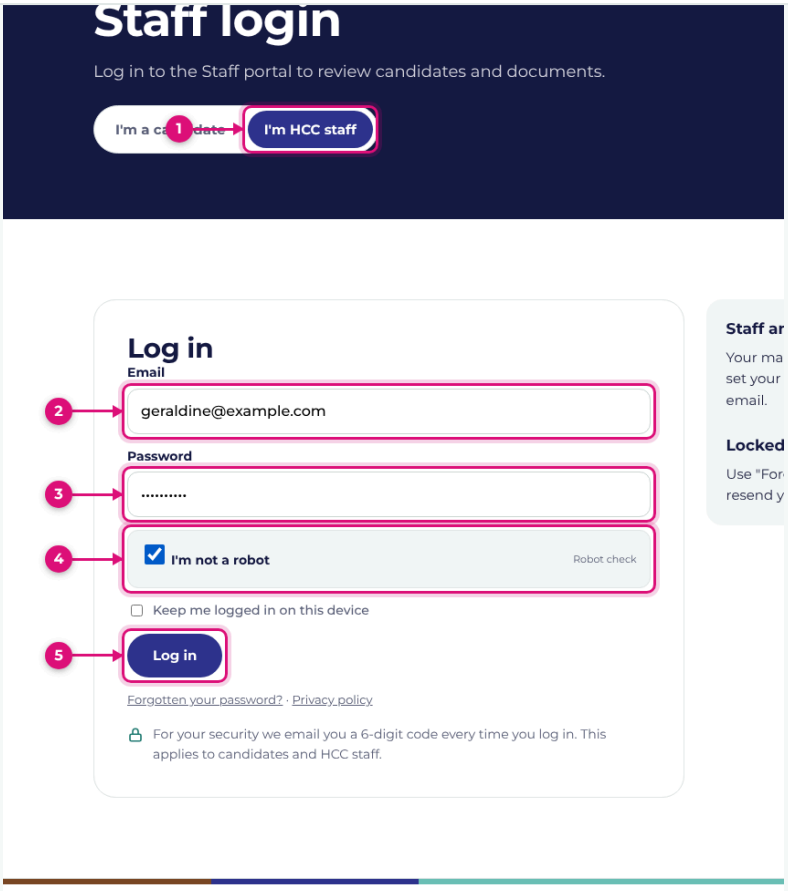
Access	Can do

HCC Staff	Everything in the Staff portal for candidates. Sees only the last 4 digits of bank details.
HCC Manager	As Staff, plus sees bank details in full and can add staff from the **Team** page.
Administrator	Everything, including the WordPress dashboard (jobs, settings, user accounts, deleting records).

STAFF PORTAL

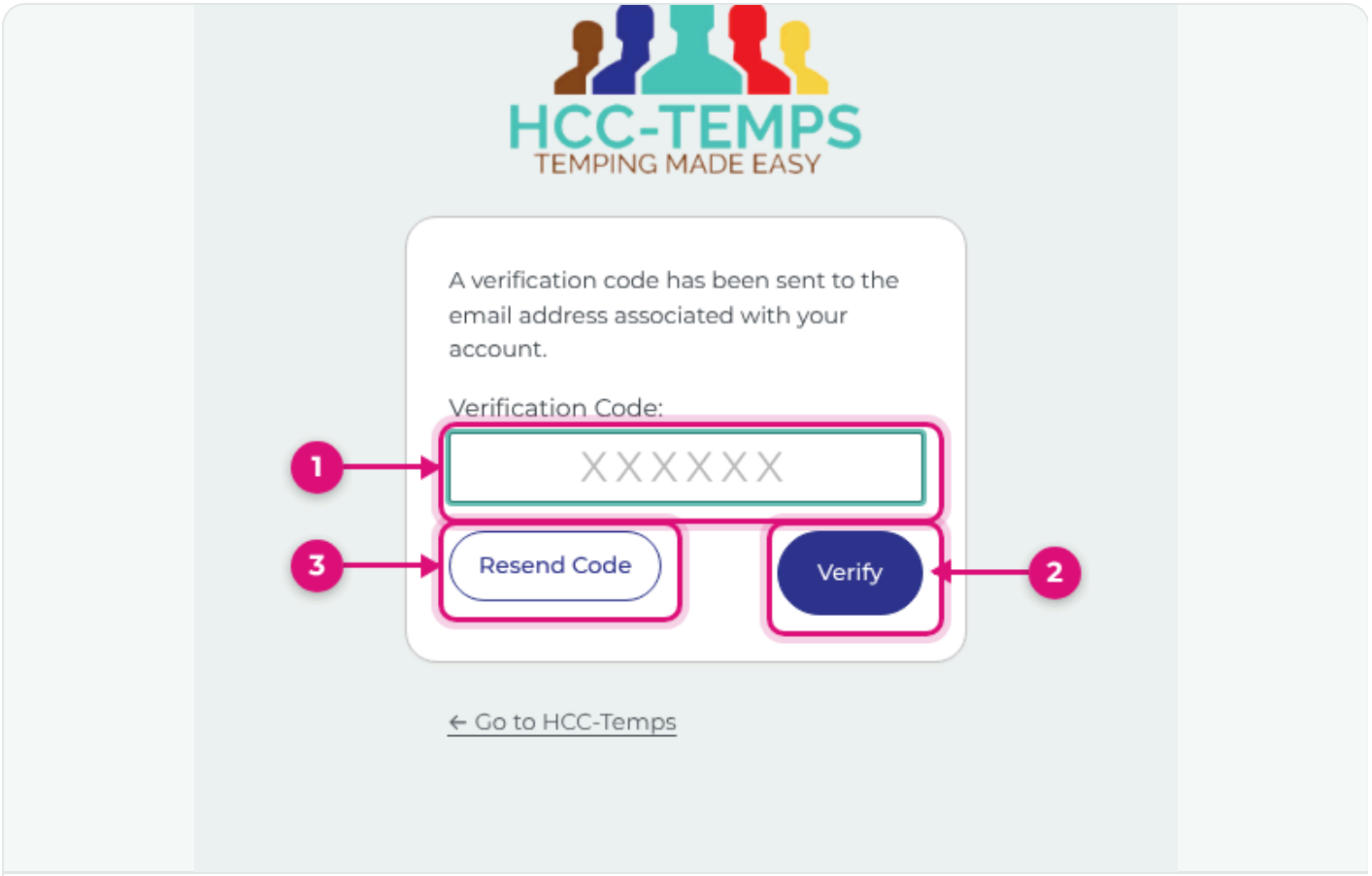
Logging in

On the website, choose **Log in → Staff login**, or go straight to **hcctemps.co.uk/candidate-login/?for=staff**.



The Staff login page.

1. Make sure **I'm HCC staff** is selected at the top.
2. Type your work email.
3. Type your password.
4. Tick **I'm not a robot**. Sometimes a short sum appears here instead ("Prove your humanity"): type the answer.
5. Press **Log in**.



Every login asks for a code sent to your email.

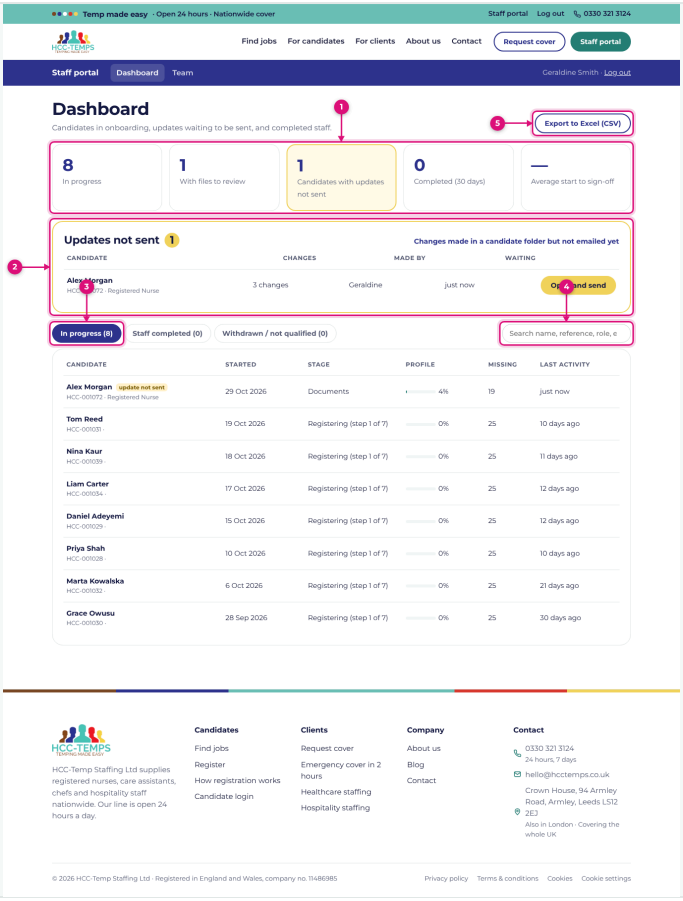
1. Type the 6-digit code from the email "Your HCC-Temps login code". It works for 15 minutes.
2. Press **Verify** (it often logs you in on its own once the 6 digits are typed).
3. No email? Check spam, then press **Resend Code**. Only the newest code works.

> **Tip**
> If you clicked a link in an email (for example "Open in Staff portal" for one candidate), you'll land on that candidate after logging in.

STAFF PORTAL

The dashboard

The first page after logging in. Go back to it any time with **Dashboard** in the dark blue bar.



Dashboard.

1. **Figures at a glance**: candidates in progress, candidates with files to review, candidates with updates not sent, completed in the last 30 days, and the average days from registering to sign-off.
2. **Updates not sent**: candidates where someone made changes (approvals, replace requests, notes) but hasn't pressed Send yet. It shows who made the changes and how long they've waited. Press **Open and send**. Nothing is ever emailed to a candidate automatically.
3. **Tabs**: In progress, Staff completed, and Withdrawn / not qualified. Click a candidate's row to open their folder.
4. **Search** by name, reference, role, email or phone, then press Enter.
5. **Export to Excel (CSV)** downloads the list in the current tab.

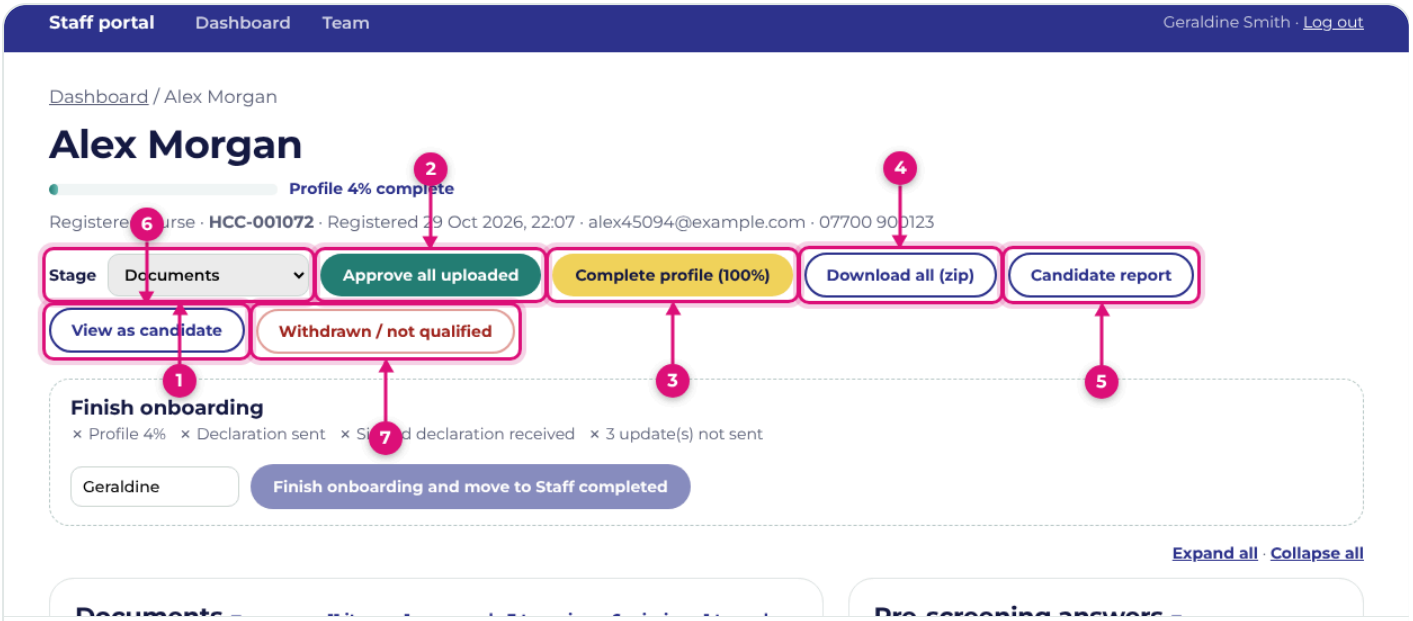
Tags on a row

"possible duplicate" means another record has the same NI number or phone number. "update not sent" means the tray has unsent changes.

STAFF PORTAL

A candidate's folder

Everything about one candidate is on one page: documents and training on the left, then answers, the update tray, checks, references, declaration, bank details, notes and the activity log on the right. Use **Expand all** / **Collapse all** to open or fold every section.



The buttons at the top of the folder.

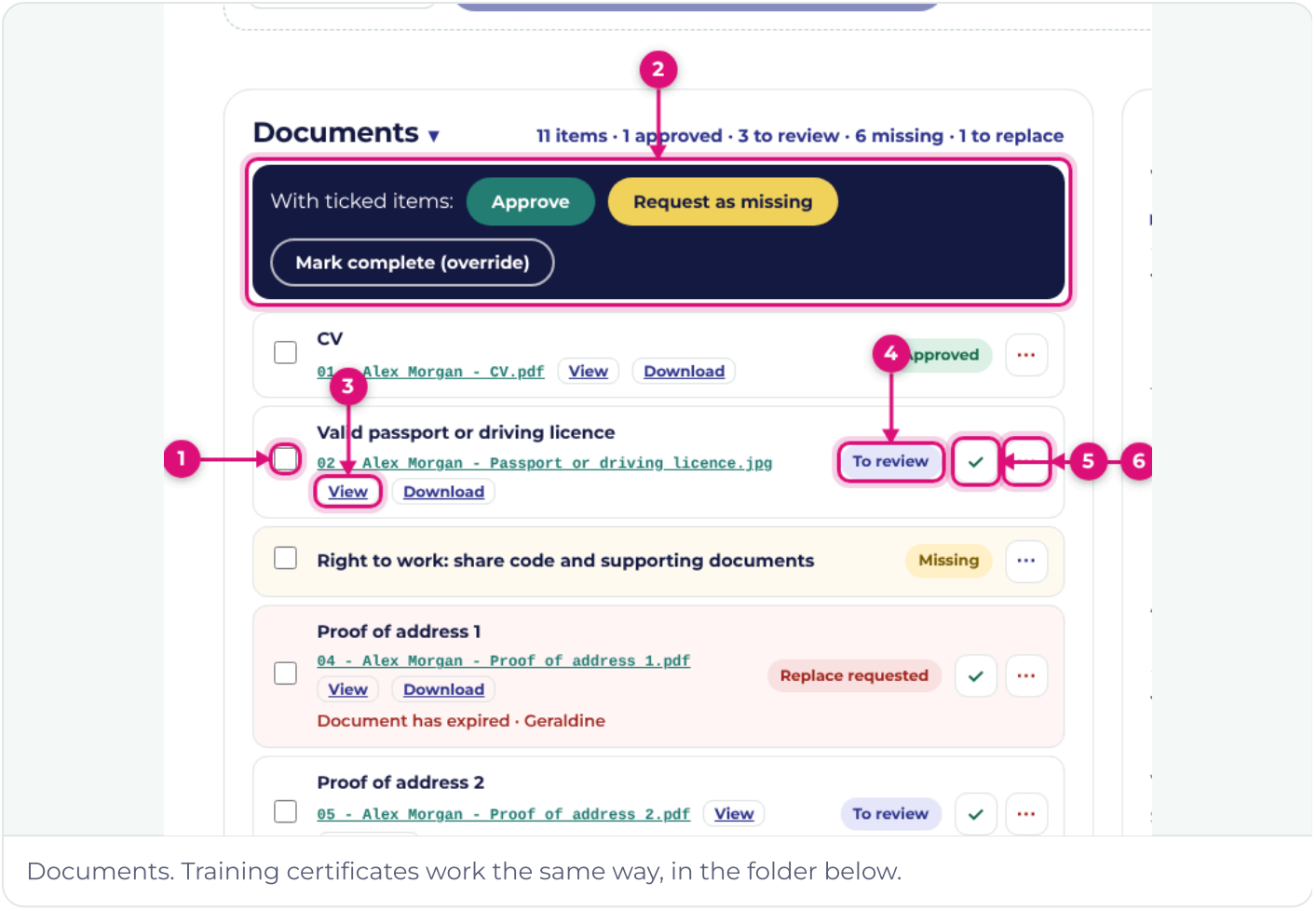
1. **View as candidate**: opens their portal read-only in a new tab, exactly as they see it.
2. **Approve all uploaded**: approves every document that is uploaded and waiting for review.
3. **Complete profile (100%)**: approves what's uploaded, then asks you to override each remaining item one at a time, with a reason and a note (see Mark complete).
4. **Download all (zip)**: every file in checklist order, plus a summary page.
5. **Candidate report**: everything on one printable page.
6. **Stage**: a label for where the candidate is (New registration, Documents, Checks in progress, Ready to work). Changing it saves straight away.
7. **Withdrawn / not qualified**: closes the application (see Finishing or closing).

Possible duplicate

If a pink box says "Possible duplicate", open the other record to check. If it's a different person, press **Checked: not a duplicate**.

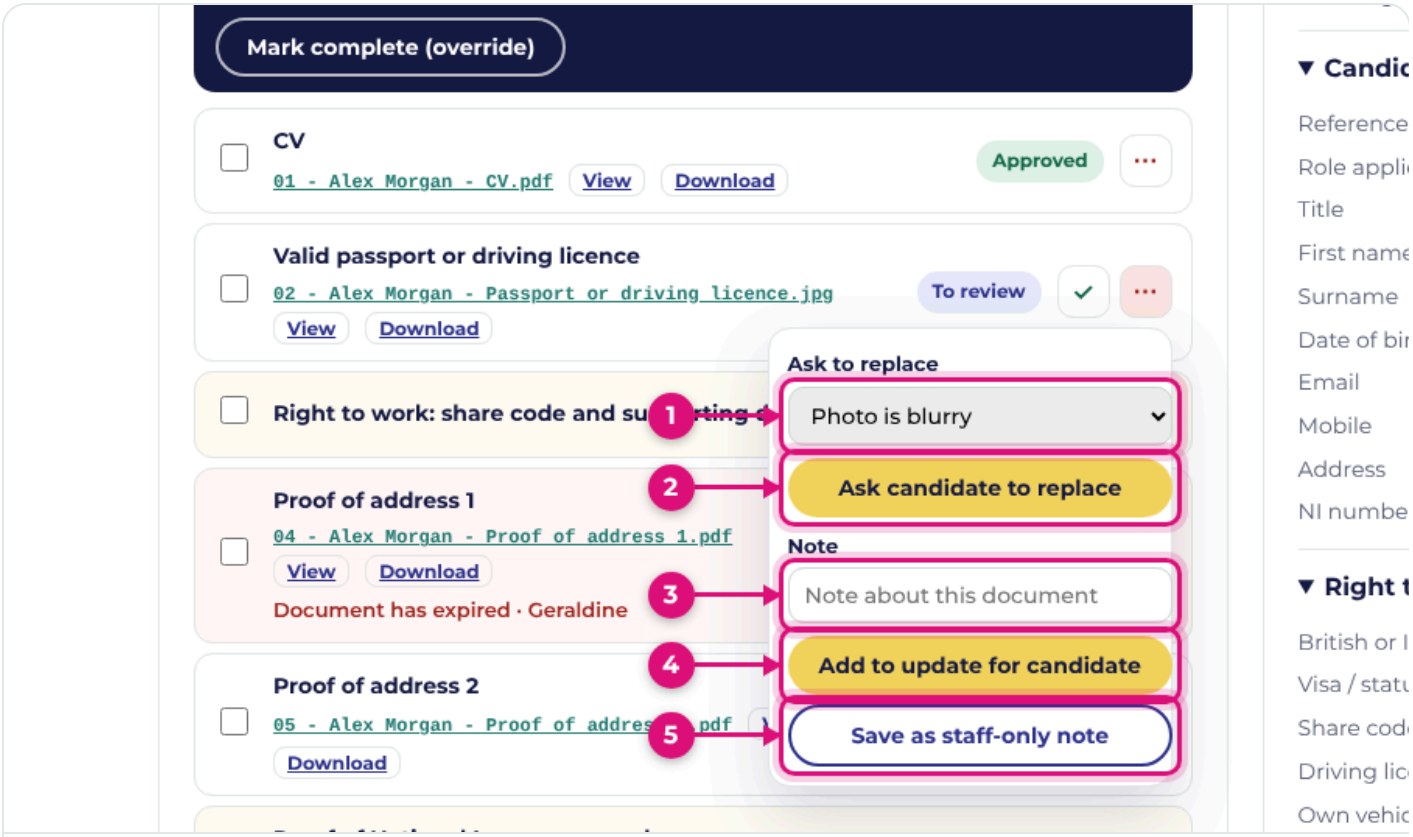
STAFF PORTAL

Reviewing documents



Documents. Training certificates work the same way, in the folder below.

1. **Tick boxes**: tick several items to act on them together.
2. **With ticked items**: **Approve** (only items that have a file), **Request as missing**, or **Mark complete (override)**.
3. **View** opens the file in a new tab. **Download** saves it. Both are recorded in the activity log.
4. **Status**: To review, Approved, Replace requested, Requested, Missing, Completed by staff, Not needed.
5. ✓ approves this one document.
6. ⋯ opens more actions for this document.



The ⋯ menu on a document.

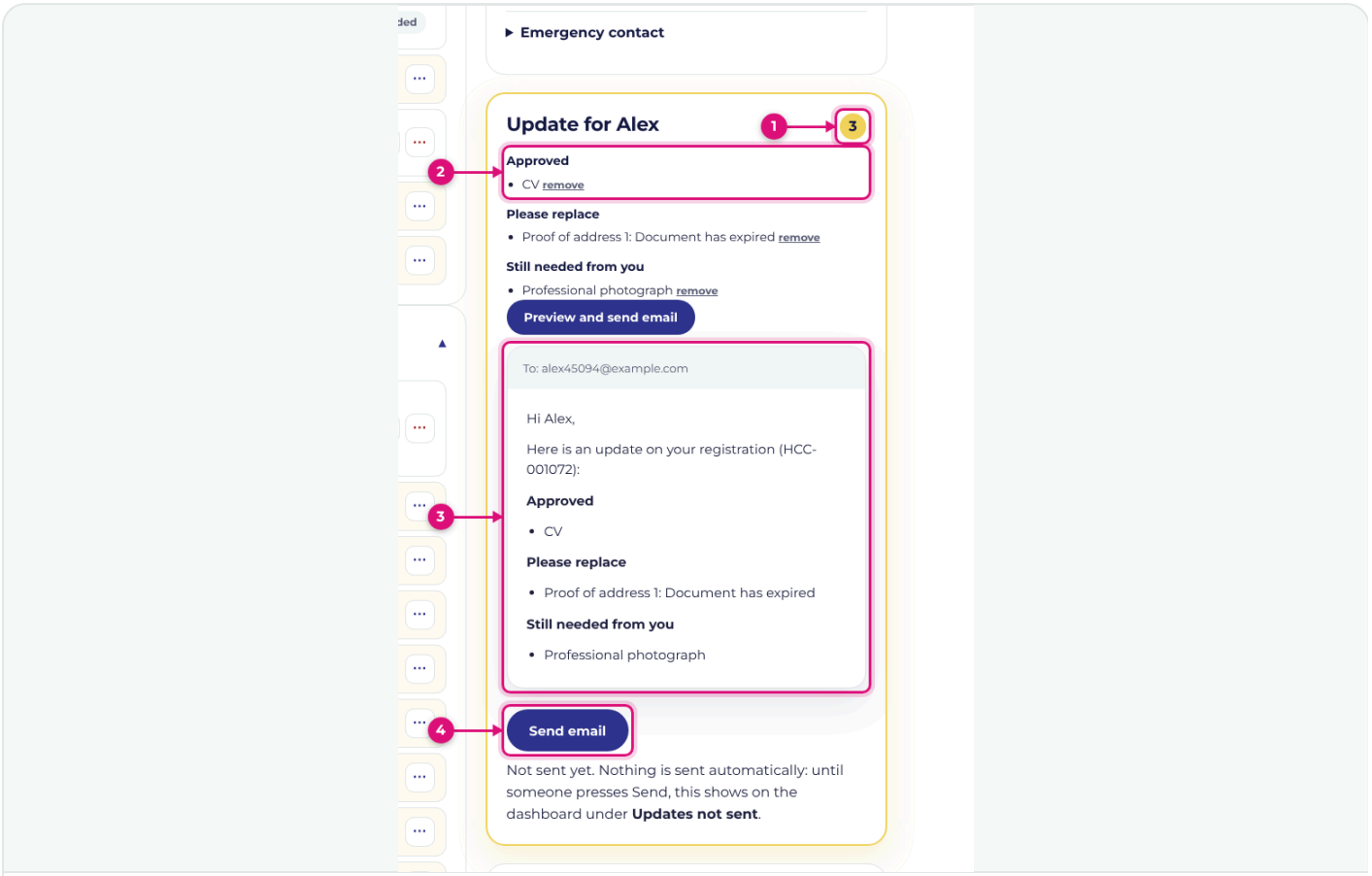
1. Choose why it needs replacing (blurry, corners cut off, expired, name doesn't match, wrong document, both sides needed).
2. **Ask candidate to replace** adds the request to the update for the candidate.
3. Type a note about this document.
4. **Add to update for candidate**: the note goes to the candidate in the next update email, and shows on that document in their portal.
5. **Save as staff-only note**: never shown to the candidate.

> **When a candidate replaces a file**
> The document goes back to "To review", the old file is kept (the new one is named "(v2)"), and the staffing inbox gets one "[DOCUMENTS]" email listing everything they uploaded in that visit.

STAFF PORTAL

The update email to the candidate

Approvals, replace requests, missing items and notes for the candidate all collect in the **Update for [name]** card at the top right. They go in **one** email when you press Send. Nothing is sent automatically.



The update tray with the email preview open.

1. The number of changes waiting.
2. The changes, grouped. Press **remove** next to one to take it out of this email (the approval itself stays).
3. **Preview and send email** shows exactly what the candidate will receive.
4. Press **Send email**. The update also appears in the candidate's portal and in the **Sent to candidate** card.

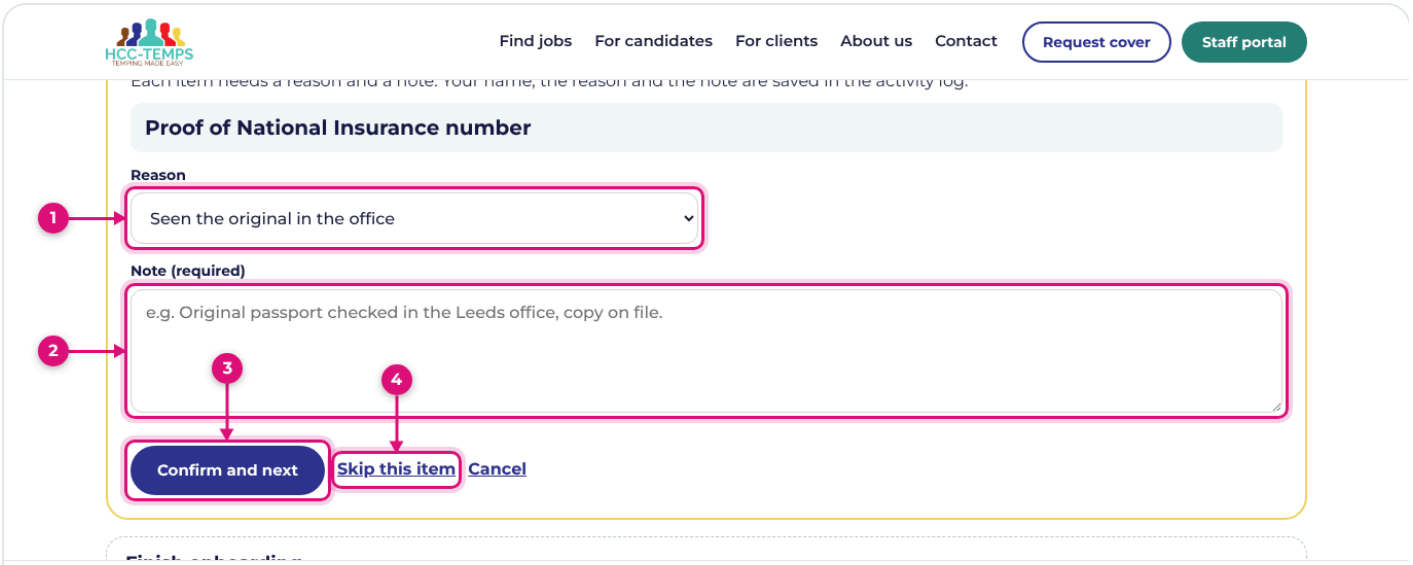
Don't forget to send

Unsent changes show on the dashboard under **Updates not sent** until someone presses Send. You can't finish onboarding while changes are unsent.

STAFF PORTAL

Mark complete (override)

Use this when an item is satisfied without an upload, for example you saw the original passport in the office, or a document isn't needed for this candidate. You'll be asked about each item in turn.



Overriding one item at a time.

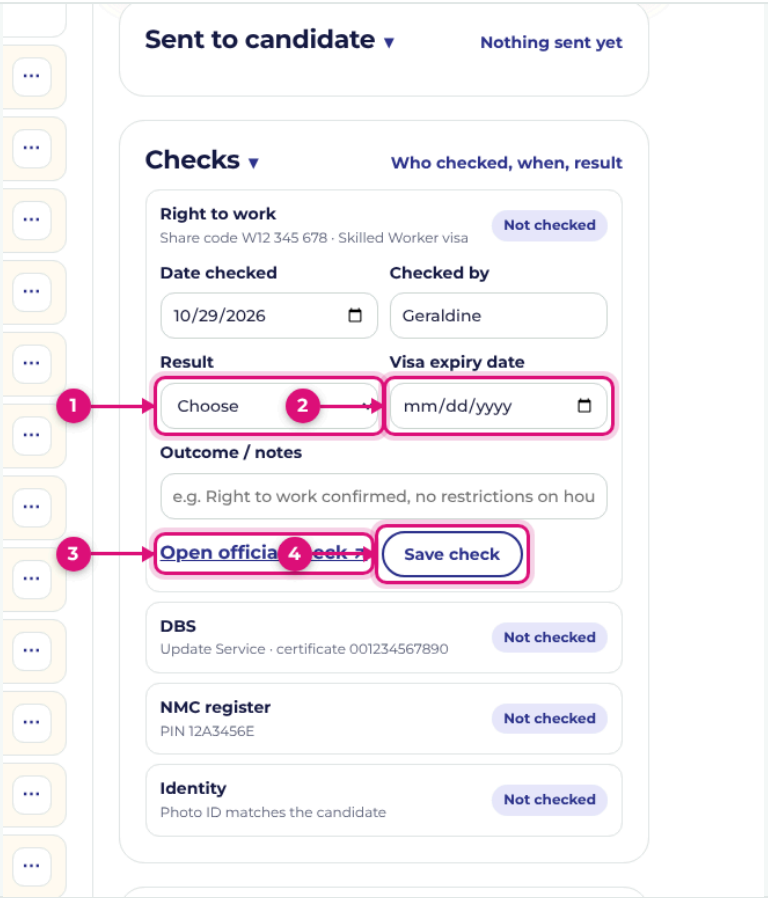
1. Choose the reason.
2. Write a note. This is required, for example "Original passport checked in the Leeds office, copy on file".
3. **Confirm and next** moves to the next item.
4. **Skip this item** leaves it as it is.

Your name, the reason and the note are saved in the activity log. Optional items ("where applicable") that weren't provided aren't counted, so you won't be asked about them.

STAFF PORTAL

Checks, references and declaration

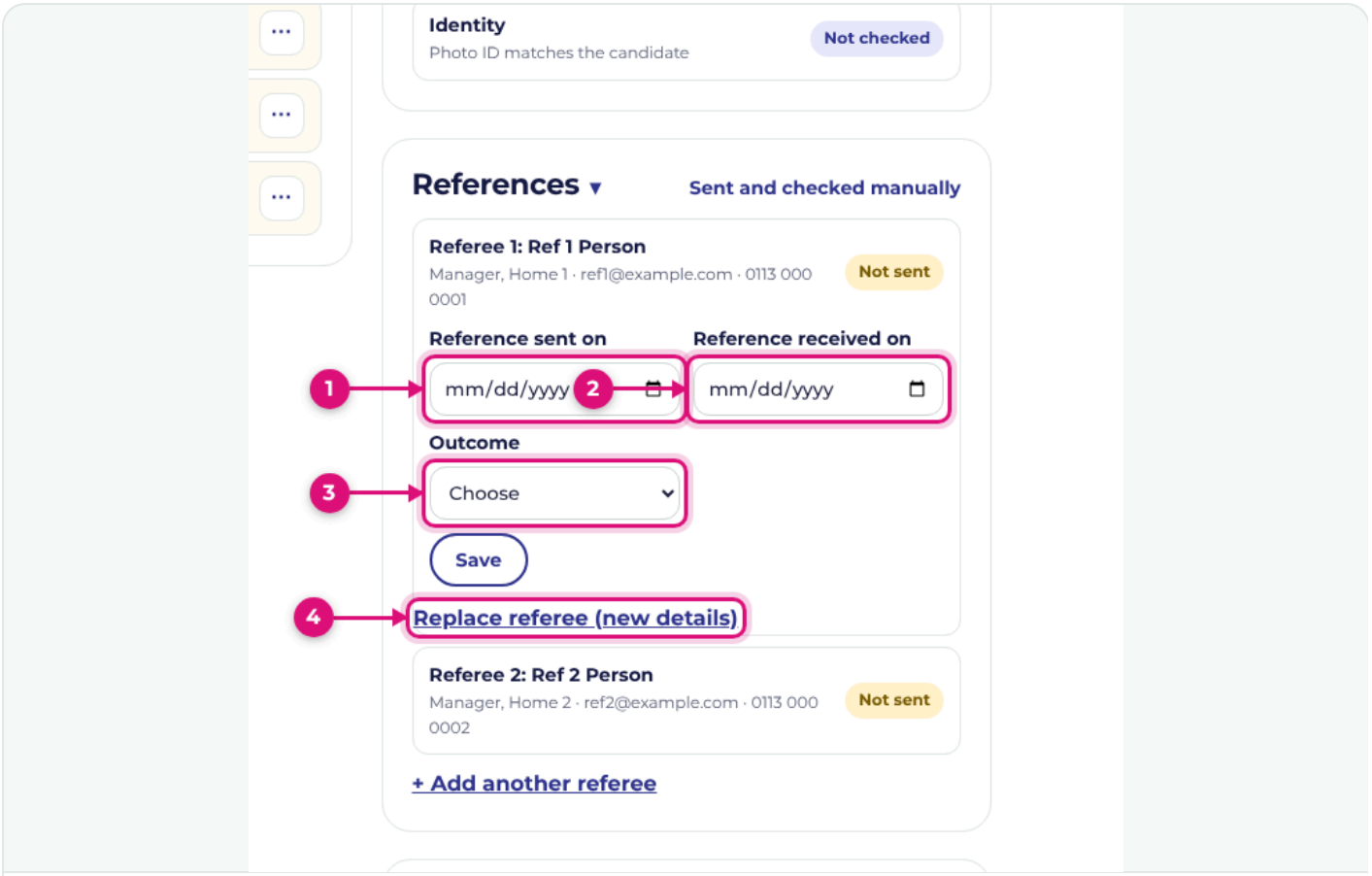
Checks



Right to work, DBS, NMC register (nurses) and identity.

1. Open a check, then choose the **Result**: Pass, Fail or Follow-up needed.
2. Fill in the visa expiry date (right to work, non-British candidates) and the outcome or notes.
3. **Open official check** opens the government or NMC website in a new tab.
4. Press **Save check**. The date and your name are filled in for you.

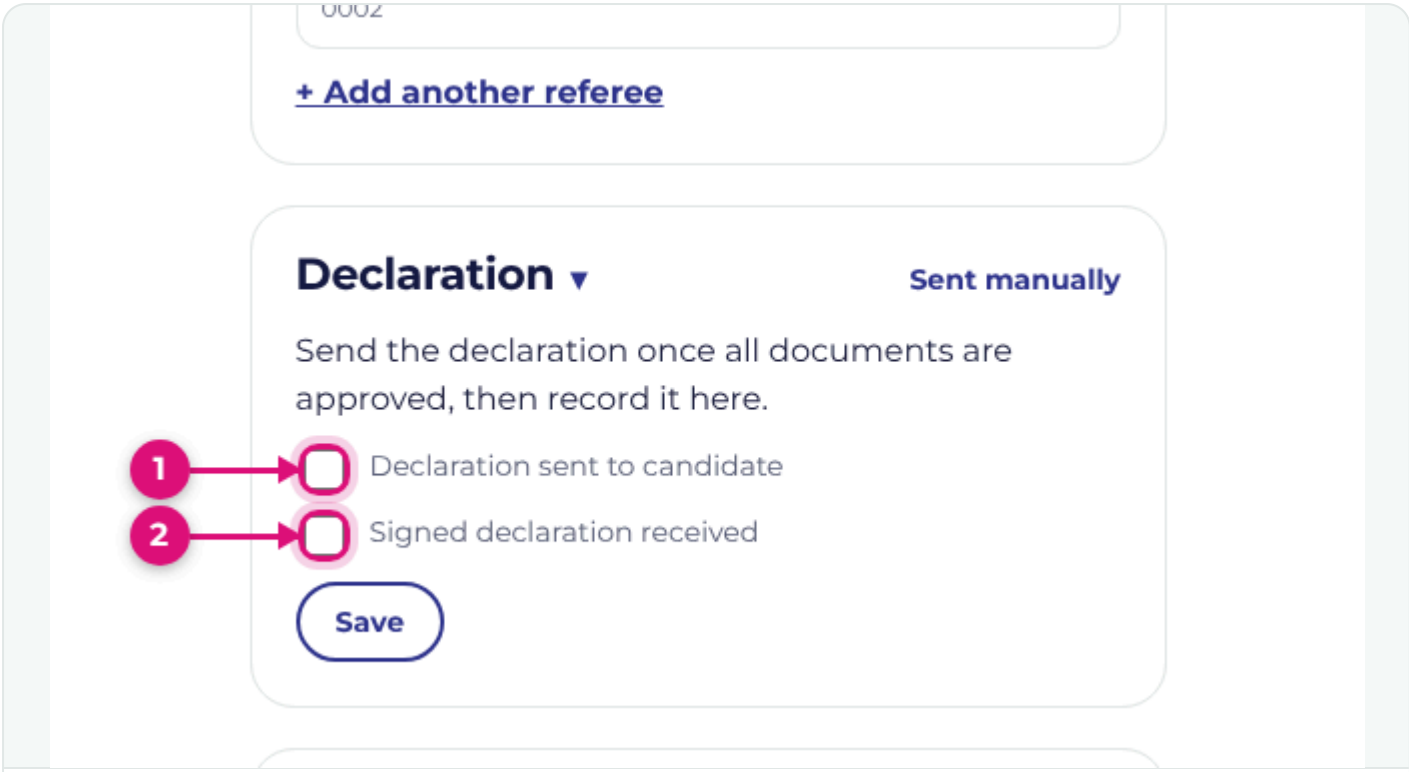
References



The two referees the candidate gave, recorded by hand.

1. The date you sent the reference request.
2. The date it came back.
3. The outcome (Satisfactory, Concerns, Not received), then **Save**.
4. **Replace referee** if one doesn't reply (the old one is kept in the history), or **+ Add another referee**.

Declaration

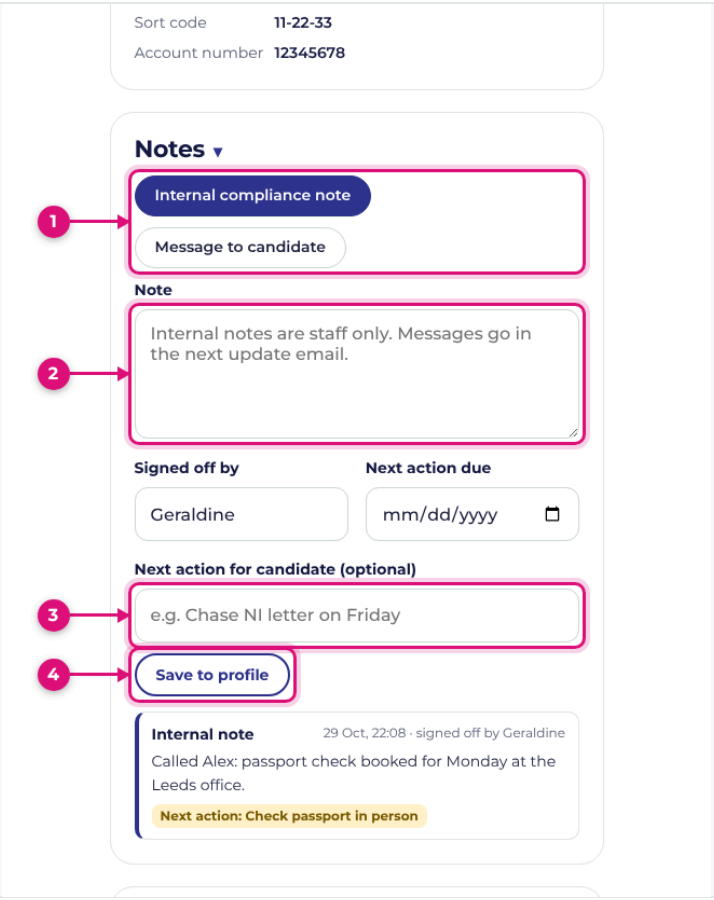


The declaration itself is sent manually; record it here.

1. Tick **Declaration sent to candidate** when you send it.
2. Tick **Signed declaration received** when it comes back, then press **Save**.

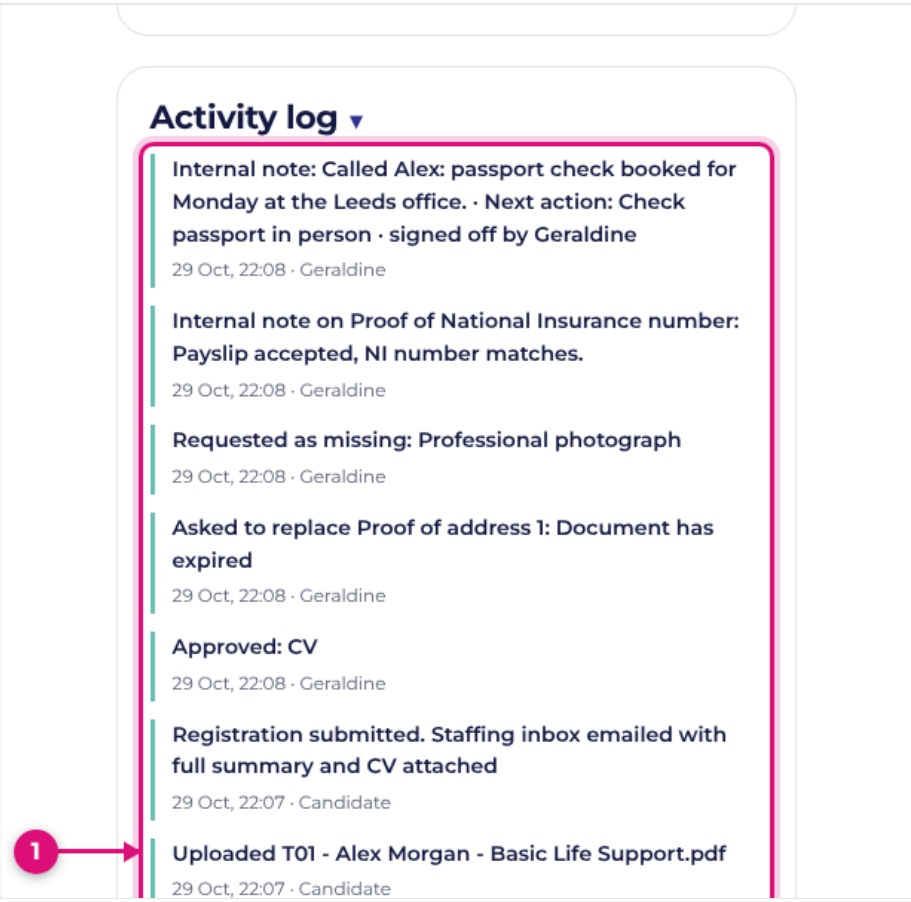
STAFF PORTAL

Notes and the activity log



Notes about the whole application.

1. Choose **Internal compliance note** (staff only) or **Message to candidate** (goes in the next update email).
2. Write the note.
3. For internal notes you can add who signed it off, the next action and when it's due. These are optional.
4. Press **Save to profile**.



The activity log, newest first.

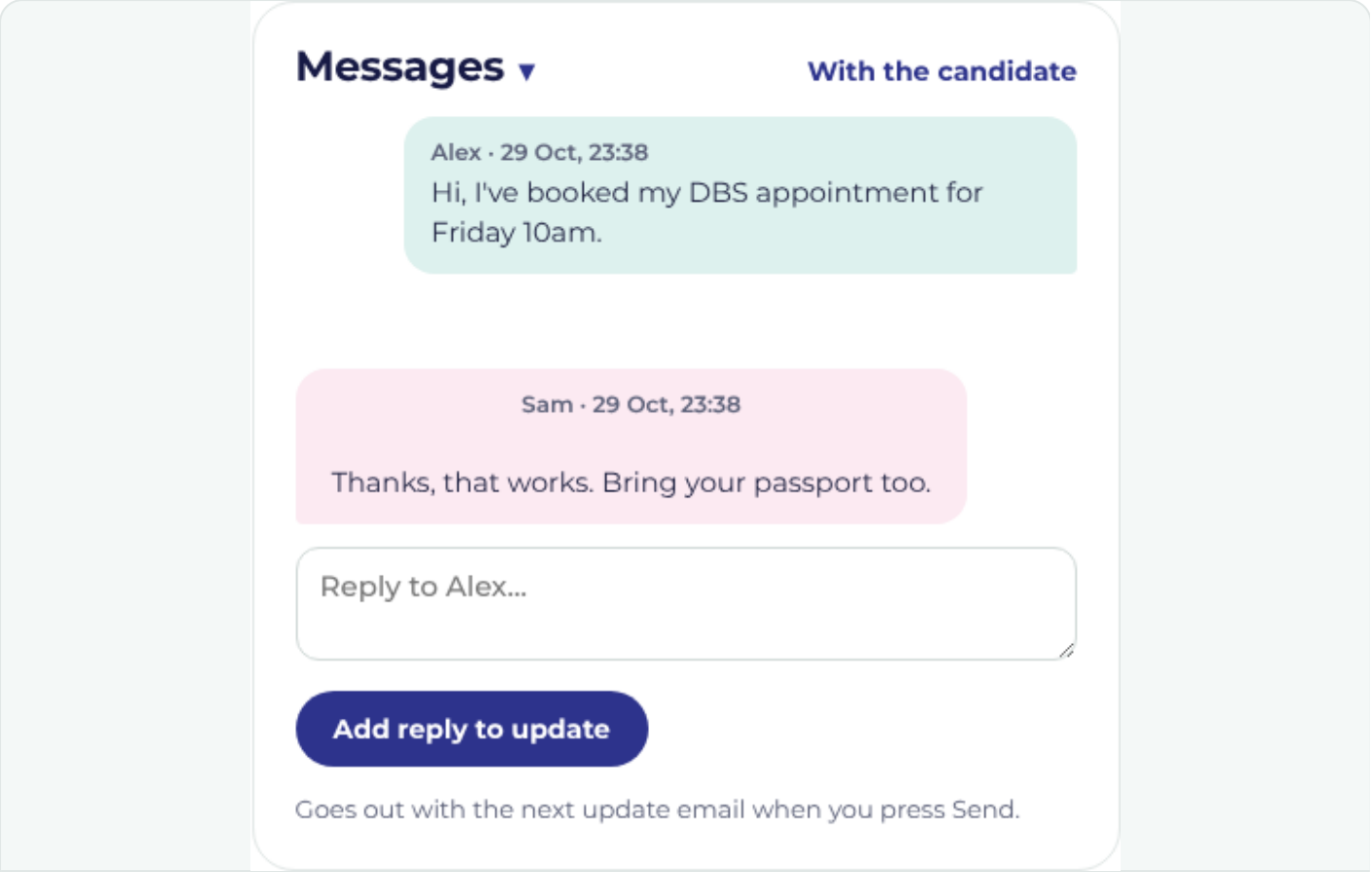
Everything is recorded with the date, time and who did it: uploads, replacements, logins, approvals, notes, checks, emails sent, views and downloads of files, and email changes.

STAFF PORTAL

Messages from candidates

Candidates can write to the team from the **Messages** section of their portal (up to 10 messages a day). When they do:

- The staffing inbox gets an email **"[MESSAGE] HCC-001072 Alex Morgan: ..."** with an **Open and reply in the Staff portal** button.
- The dashboard shows a pink **New messages** box, and the candidate's row gets a **new message** tag. Both clear once someone opens the folder (the activity log records who opened it).



The Messages card in the candidate's folder: their messages on the right, the team's on the left.

1. New messages are outlined in pink.
2. Type your reply and press **Add reply to update**. Like every message to a candidate, it goes out when you press **Send email** in the update tray, and then appears in their portal conversation.

Replying by email

Replying to the [MESSAGE] email goes straight to the candidate, but it won't be recorded in their folder. Replying in the Staff portal keeps everything in one place.

STAFF PORTAL

Training reminders and the e-learning portal

Candidates who are missing training certificates can **buy** the courses on HCC's e-learning portal (VideoTile), do them online, then **download the certificate and upload it in their portal** under Training. Staff review it like any other upload.

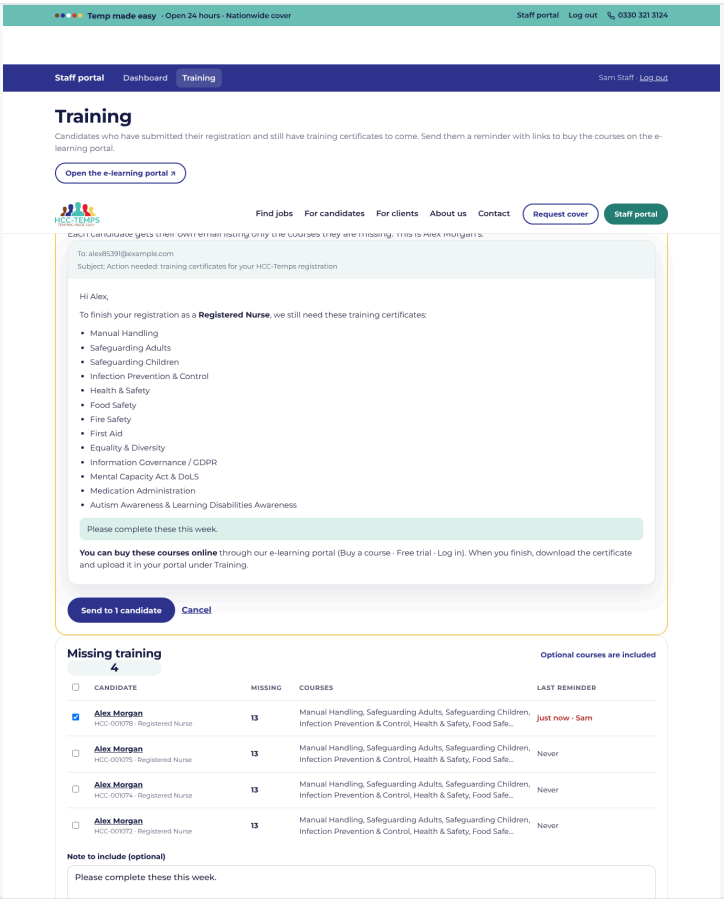
What candidates see

- **Registration (Training step):** a box with **Buy a course**, **Free trial** and **Log in** links, and "Buy this course online" under each missing course.
- **Thank-you page and the "We have your registration" email:** the list of training still needed, with the same links.
- **Their portal (Training):** "You still need X training certificates", the list, the links, and **Ask the team to get you set up**, which opens Messages with a request already written.

Reminding one candidate

1. Open their folder and the **Training certificates** section. It shows how many are missing and when they were last reminded.
2. Press **Send training reminder**. Every missing course is ticked: untick any you don't want to include, and add a note if you like.
3. Press **Add to update**. The courses go into the update tray under "Training still needed", with the buy links, and go out when you press **Send email**, together with any other updates.

Reminding many candidates at once



Training, in the dark blue bar: the preview at the top, the list underneath.

1. Open **Training** in the dark blue bar. It lists every candidate who has submitted and still has training to come (optional courses included): how many are missing, which ones, and when they were last reminded (in red if within the last 3 days).
2. Tick the candidates (or the box at the top for everyone) and add a note if you like.
3. Press **Preview training reminders**. Check the preview: each candidate gets their own email listing only the courses **they** are missing.
4. Press **Send to X candidates**. Emails go straight away. Each is recorded in the candidate's activity log, Sent to candidate card and portal Updates.

The e-learning portal address

It's set in `Appearance → Customize → HCC-Temps → Homepage → E-learning portal`. **Open the e-learning portal** on the Training page takes you there.

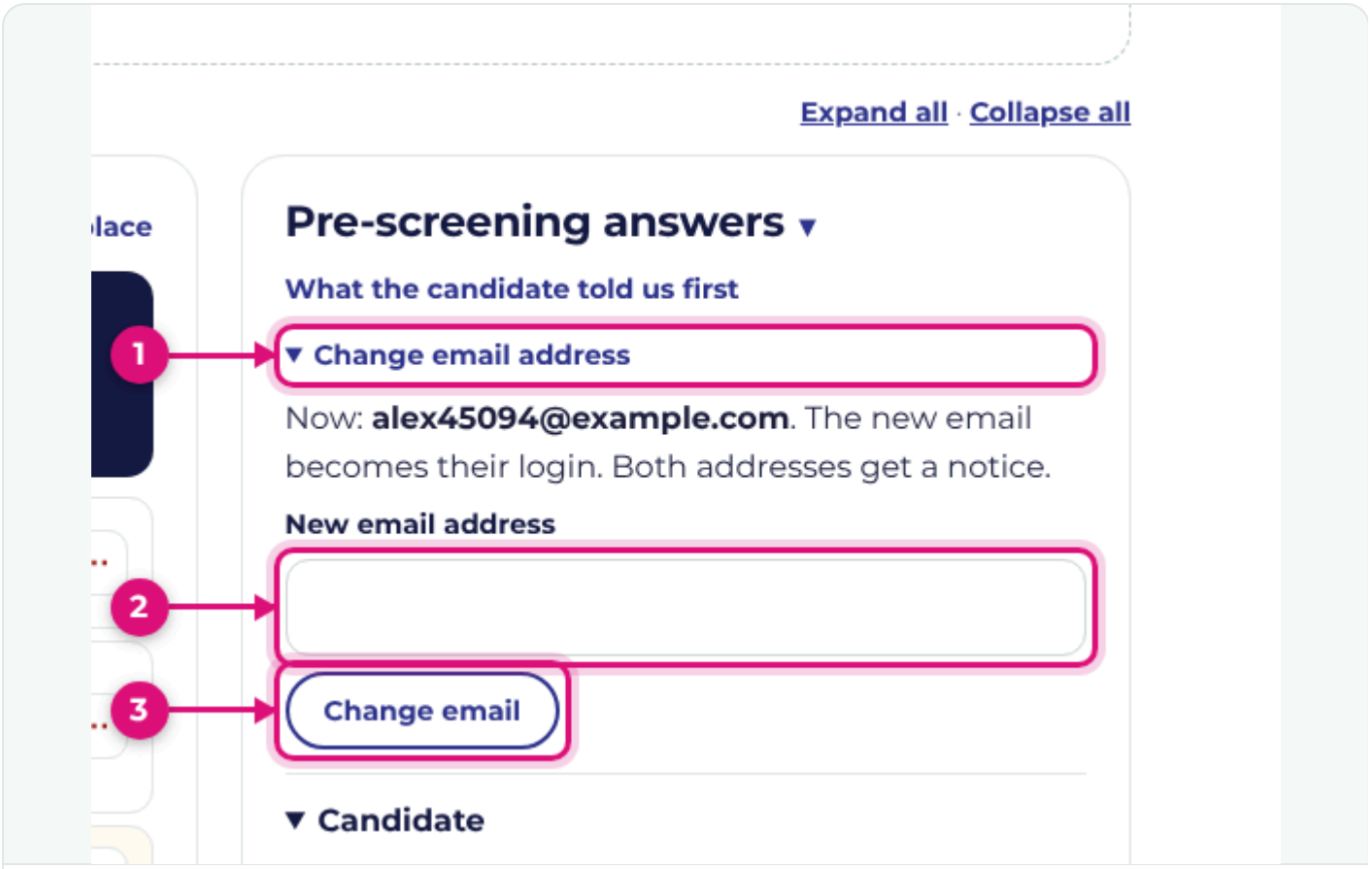
STAFF PORTAL

Changing a candidate's email

If a candidate typed their email wrongly or has a new one, they can fix it themselves:

- **While registering:** on the "Check your email" step, **Wrong email address? Change it**.
- **After registering:** in their portal, under My answers, **Change my email address**. A code is sent to the new address.

If they phone you instead, change it from their folder:

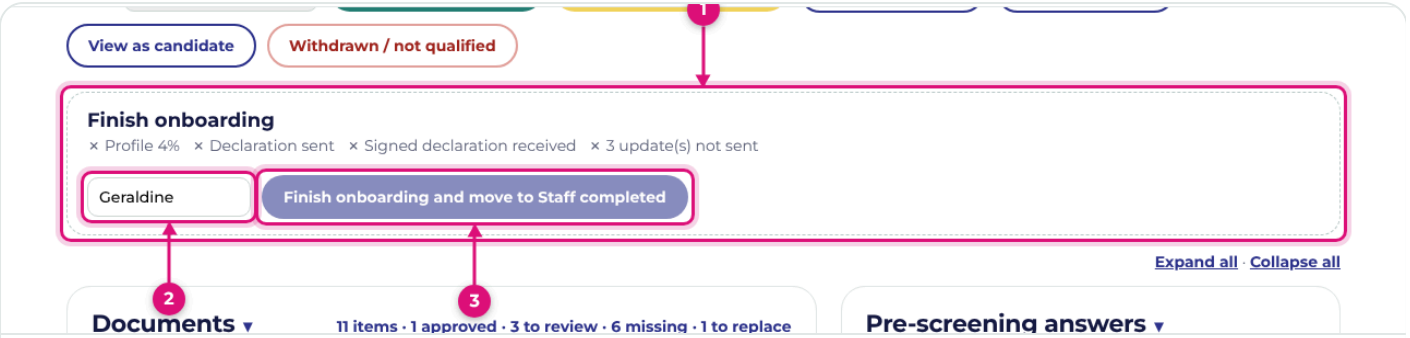


At the top of Pre-screening answers.

1. Open **Change email address**.
2. Type the new email.
3. Press **Change email**. It becomes their login straight away. The old and new addresses both get a short notice, and it's written in the activity log.

STAFF PORTAL

Finishing onboarding, or closing

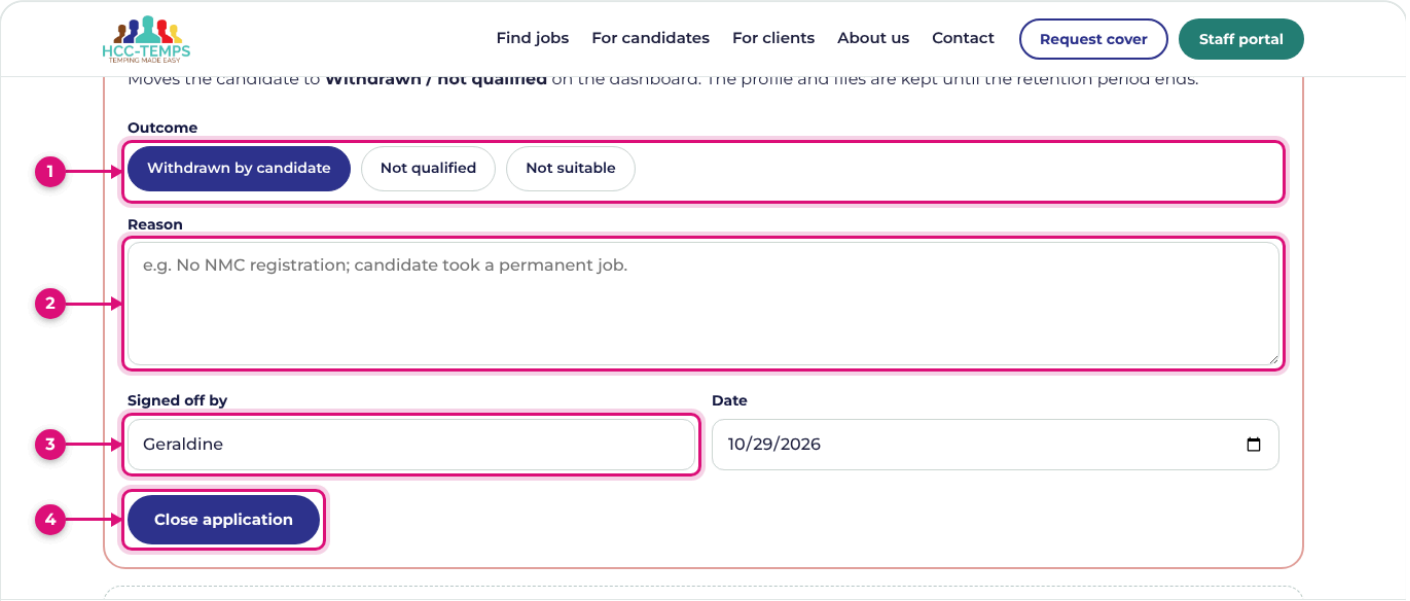


The Finish onboarding box shows what's still needed.

1. Each condition shows ✓ or ×: profile 100%, declaration sent, signed declaration received, no unsent updates.
2. The name of the person signing off.
3. When everything is ✓, press **Finish onboarding and move to Staff completed**. The candidate gets a "ready to work" email.

> **Made a mistake?**
> On a completed candidate, press **Move back to in progress**. The sign-off is removed and the change is logged.

Withdrawn / not qualified



Closing an application.

1. Choose the outcome: Withdrawn by candidate, Not qualified, or Not suitable.
2. Write the reason.
3. Your name (signed off by) and the date.
4. Press **Close application**. The candidate moves to the Withdrawn / not qualified tab and their portal becomes read-only. **Reopen application** brings them back.

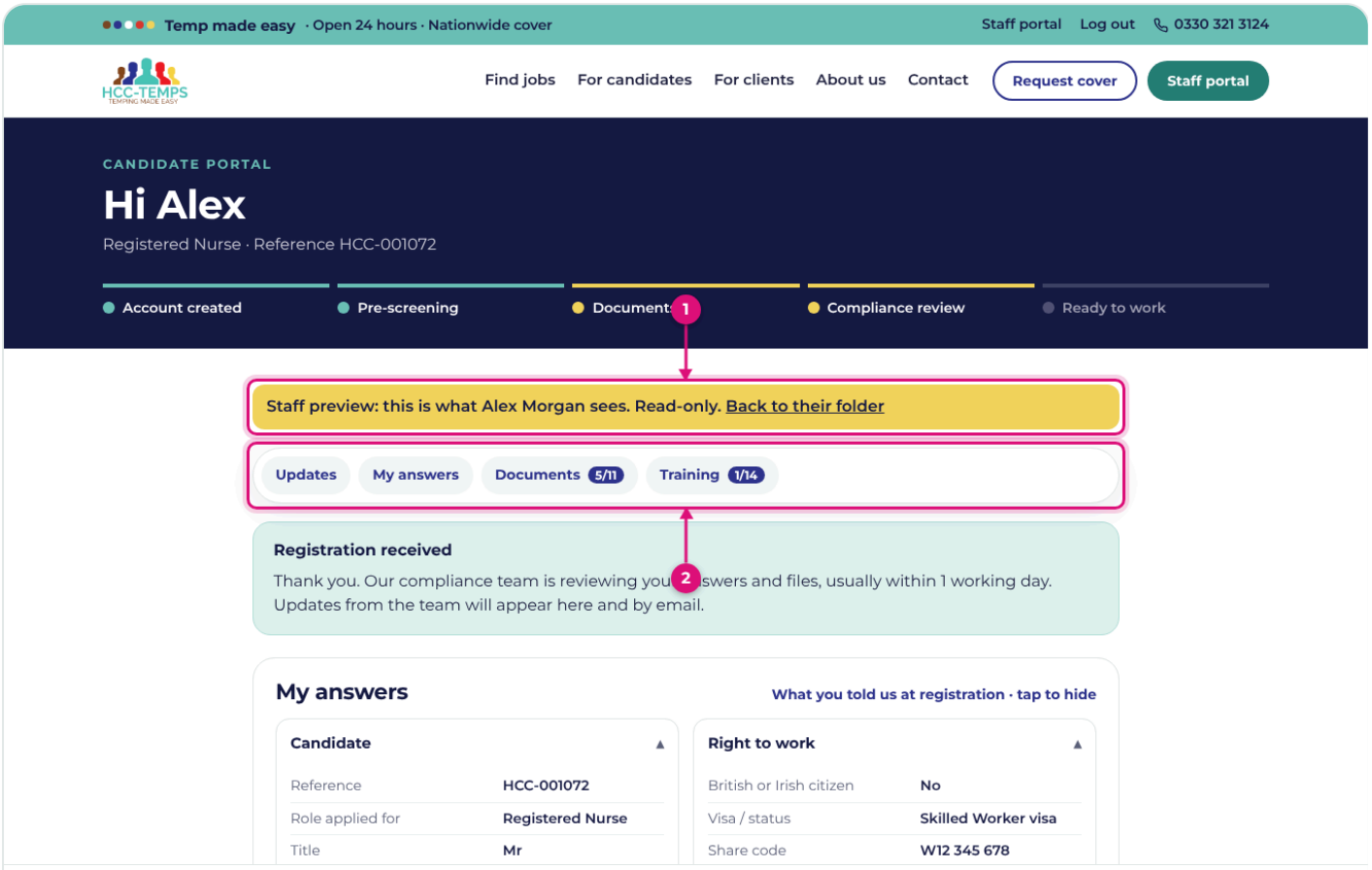
STAFF PORTAL

Viewing and downloading files

- **One file:** in the Documents list, **View** opens it in a new tab and **Download** saves it.
- **Everything: Download all (zip)** at the top of the folder. You get a folder named "HCC-001072 Alex Morgan - Registered Nurse" with documents numbered in checklist order (01 - Alex Morgan - CV.pdf…), a Training subfolder, and a summary page.
- **Printable summary: Candidate report**.

Where are the files kept?

Candidate documents are stored in a private folder on the website. They are **not** in the WordPress Media Library, and there's no public link to them. Always open them through the Staff portal: every view and download is logged. Managers see bank details in full in reports and zips; staff see the last 4 digits.



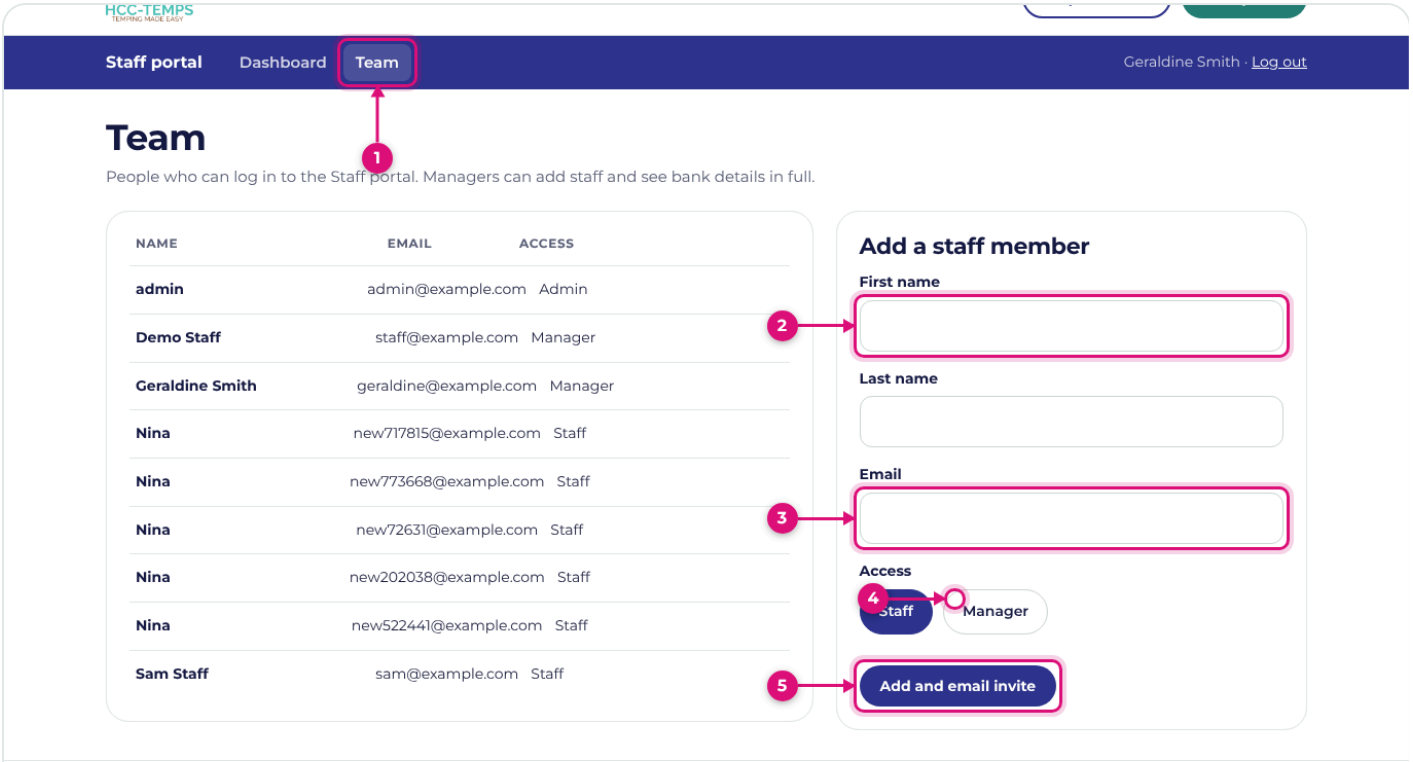
View as candidate.

1. The yellow bar shows it's a read-only staff preview. **Back to their folder** returns you.
2. The candidate's quick-jump bar: Updates, My answers, Documents, Training.

STAFF PORTAL

Adding staff to the Staff portal

Managers can add staff without going into WordPress.



Team.

1. Open **Team** in the dark blue bar (managers only).
2. First name (and last name).
3. Their work email.
4. **Staff** or **Manager** (managers see bank details in full and can add staff).
5. Press **Add and email invite**. They get an email with a link to set their password, then log in at Staff login with an emailed code.

To remove someone's access, see Admin access and login codes.

WORDPRESS DASHBOARD

Getting into the WordPress dashboard

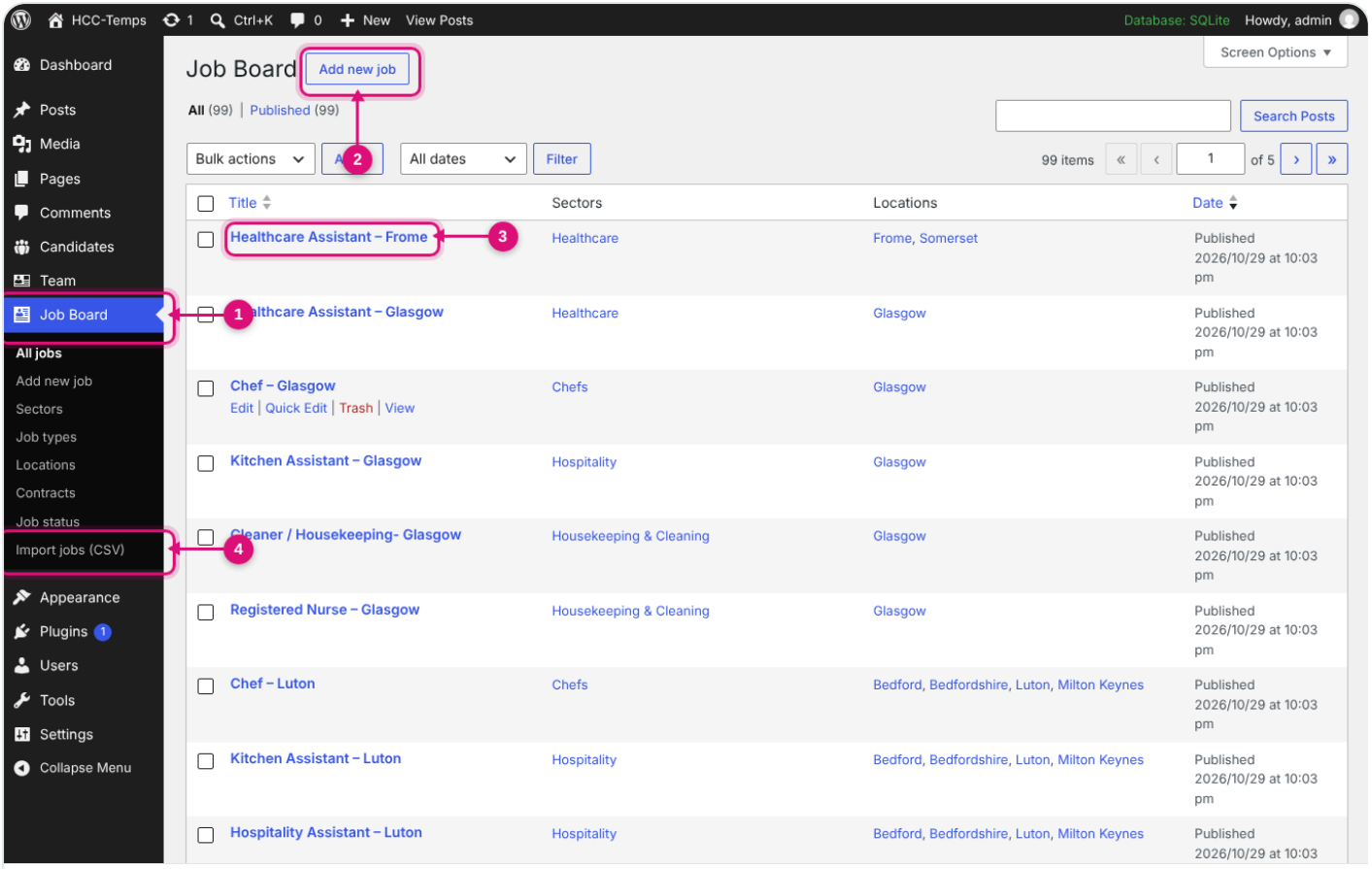
Go to **hcctemps.co.uk/wp-admin** and log in with your administrator account. The menu down the left side has the parts you'll use:

Menu	What it's for
Job Board	Job adverts: All jobs, Add new job, Sectors, Job types, Locations, Contracts, Job status, Import jobs (CSV).
Candidates	A simple list of candidate records with a link to each one in the Staff portal. Used to delete records.
Team	The people shown on the About us page.
Pages	The website pages. Their layout comes from the theme.
Appearance → Customize	Phone, emails, staffing inbox, homepage figures, links and other settings.
Users	Accounts and access levels.

WordPress.com
On WordPress.com the dashboard has an extra WordPress.com menu and may look slightly different from these screenshots. The menu items named here are the same.

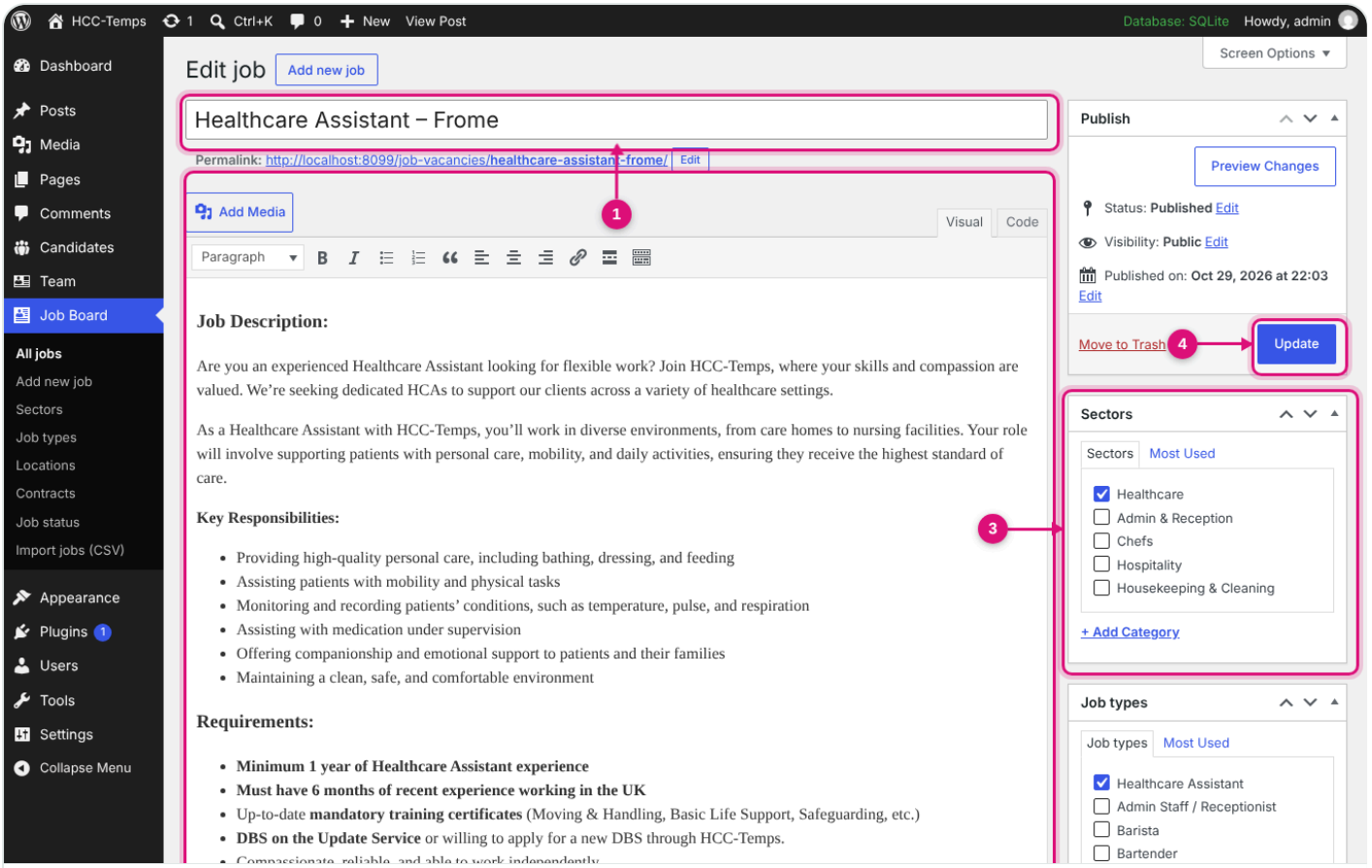
WORDPRESS DASHBOARD

Job Board: add, change, close



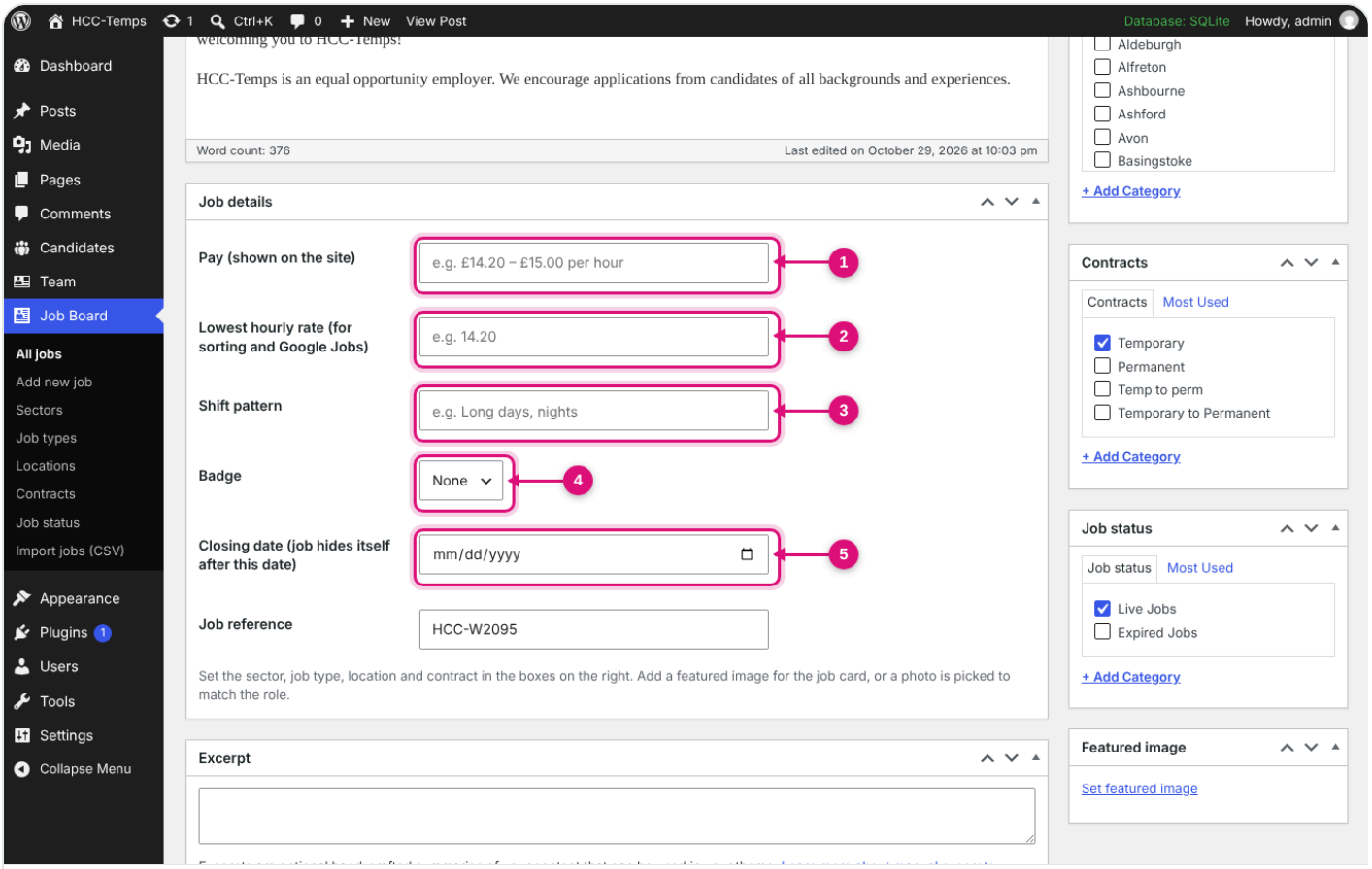
Job Board → All jobs.

1. **Job Board** in the left menu.
2. **Add new job** to create one.
3. Click a job's title to change it.
4. **Import jobs (CSV)** to add or update many jobs from a spreadsheet (next page).



Editing a job.

1. The job title, as shown on the site.
2. The description: what they'll do, what they need, what they get.
3. Tick the **Sector** on the right, and below it the **Job type**, **Location** and **Contract**. Use "+ Add" to create a new one, for example a new town.
4. Press **Publish** (new job) or **Update** (existing job).



The Job details box, under the description.

1. Pay as shown on the site, e.g. "£14.20 – £15.00 per hour".
2. The lowest hourly rate as a number, e.g. 14.20. Used for "sort by pay" and Google Jobs.
3. Shift pattern, e.g. "Long days, nights".
4. Badge: New or Urgent.
5. Closing date: the job disappears from the site by itself after this date.

To close a job

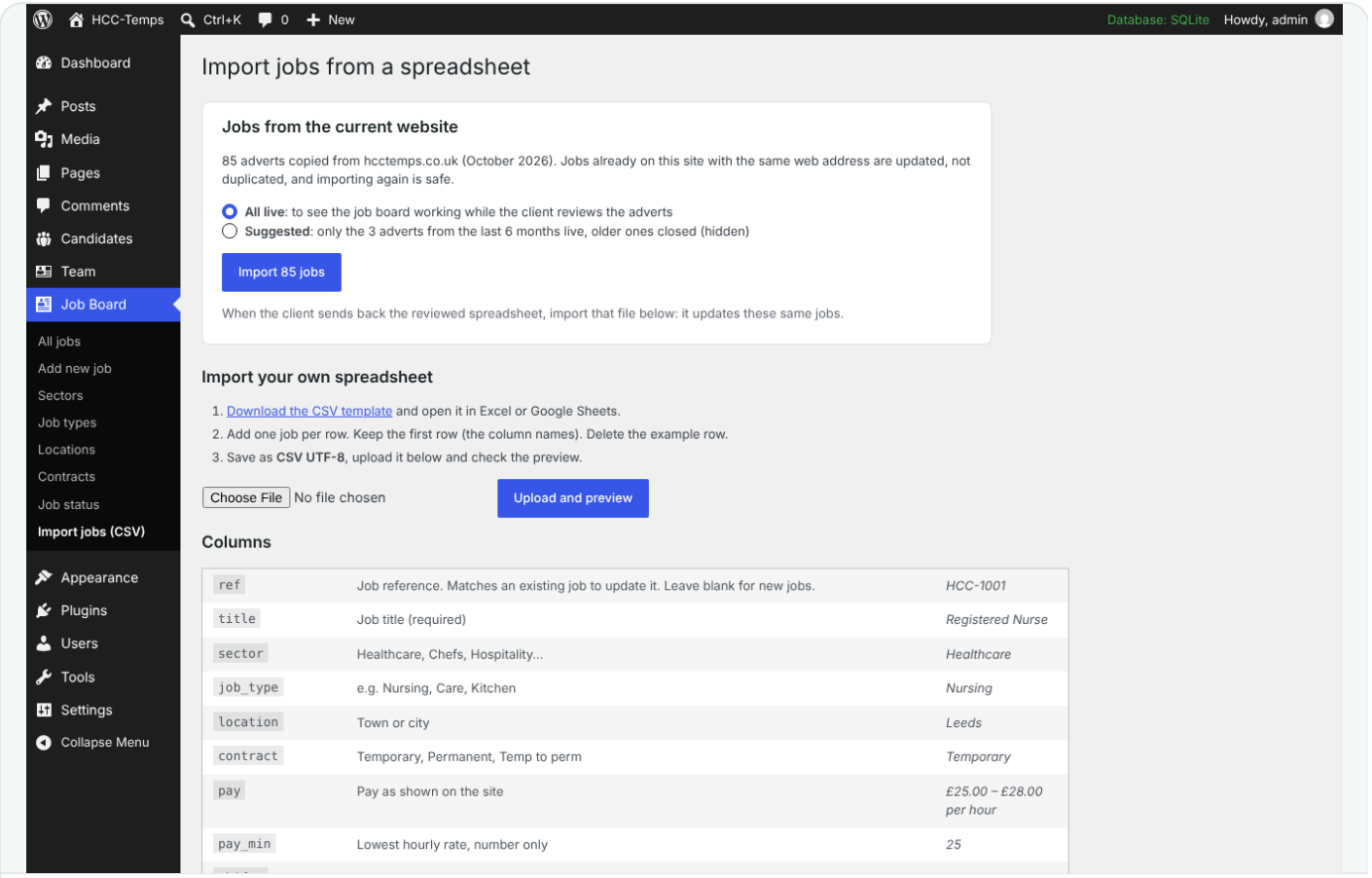
Either set a closing date in the past, or in **Job status** (right side) tick **Expired Jobs** instead of Live Jobs and press Update. Closed jobs stay in the dashboard so you can reopen them later. **Move to Trash** removes a job completely.

WORDPRESS DASHBOARD

Importing jobs from a spreadsheet

The 85 jobs from the current website

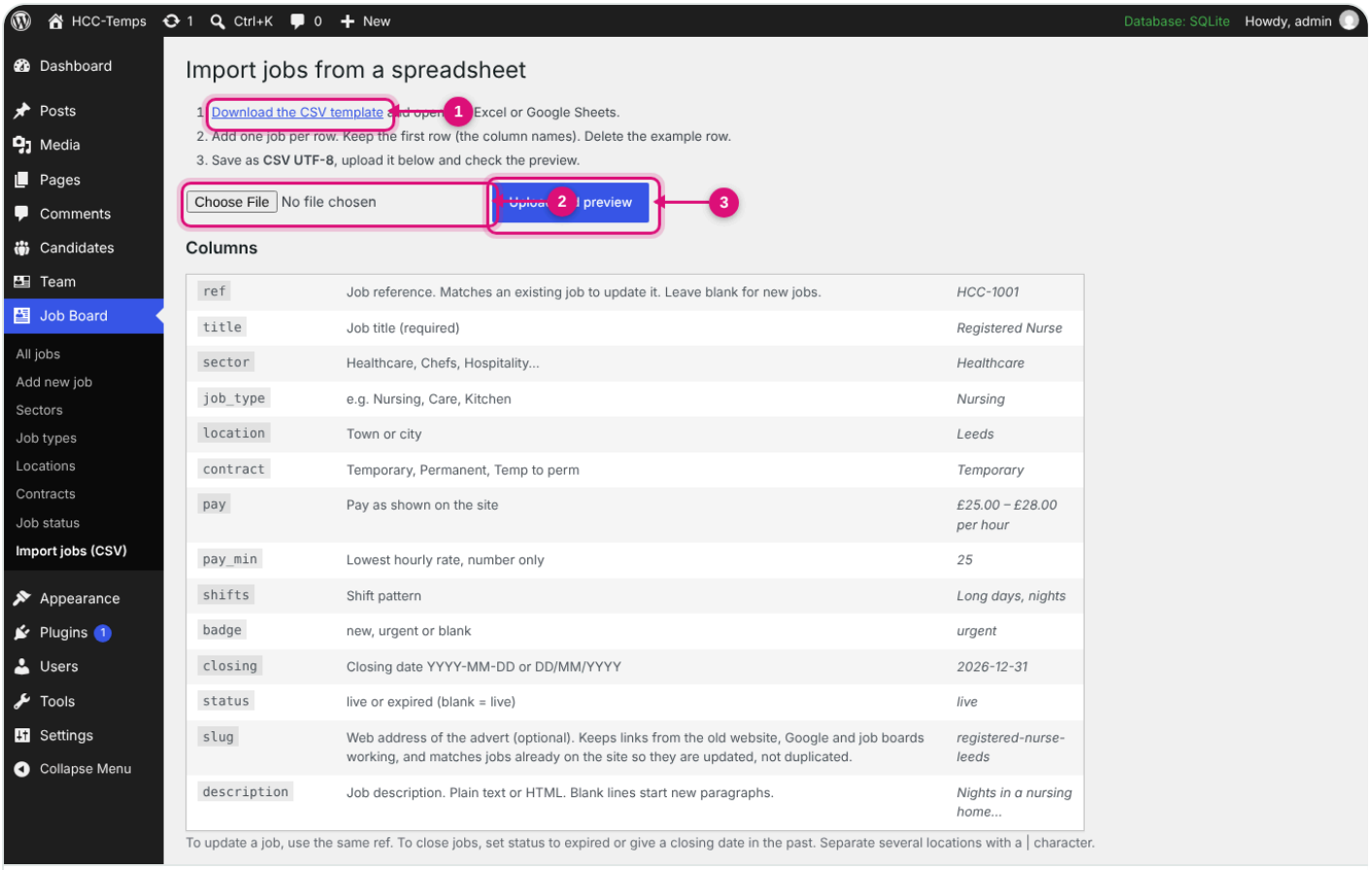
The adverts from the current hcctemps.co.uk website come with the theme. Import them in one click at the top of the Import page:



Jobs from the current website.

- **All live** shows all 85 on the job board, for example while the client reviews them. **Suggested** only shows the 3 recent ones and keeps older adverts closed.
- Leave **Also remove the sample jobs** ticked to take the theme's example jobs away.
- Press **Import 85 jobs**. It's safe to press again: jobs are updated, not duplicated.

Your own spreadsheet



Job Board → Import jobs (CSV).

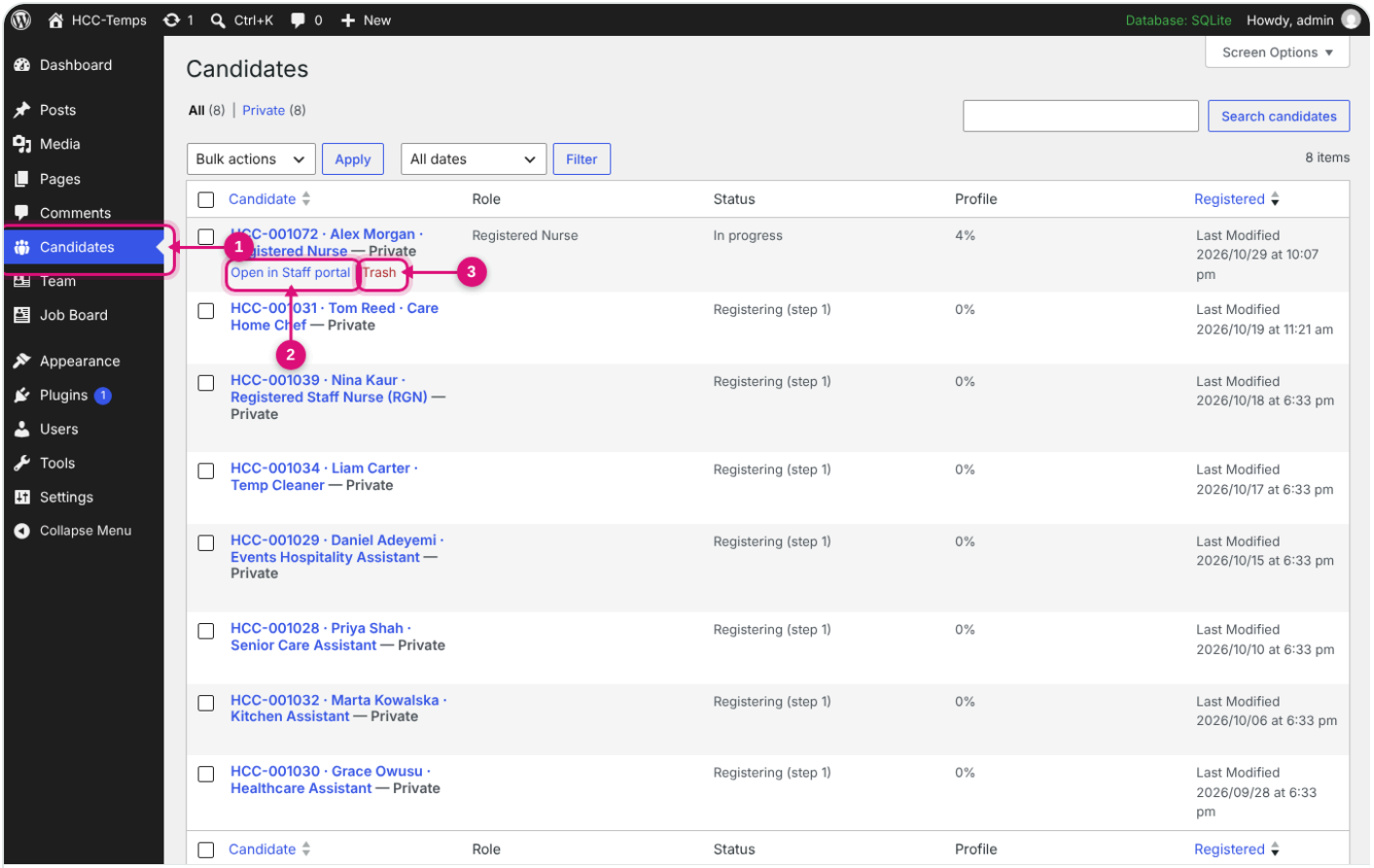
1. **Download the CSV template** and open it in Excel or Google Sheets. Keep the first row (column names); one job per row.
2. Save as **CSV UTF-8**, then choose the file.
3. Press **Upload and preview**. The preview shows each row as New, Update or Skip (with the reason). Press **Import** to finish.

> **Updating, not duplicating**
>
> A row with the same **ref** (or the same web address in the **slug** column) as an existing job updates that job. To close jobs, put **expired** in the status column. Several locations go in one cell separated by **|**, e.g. "Leeds | Bradford".

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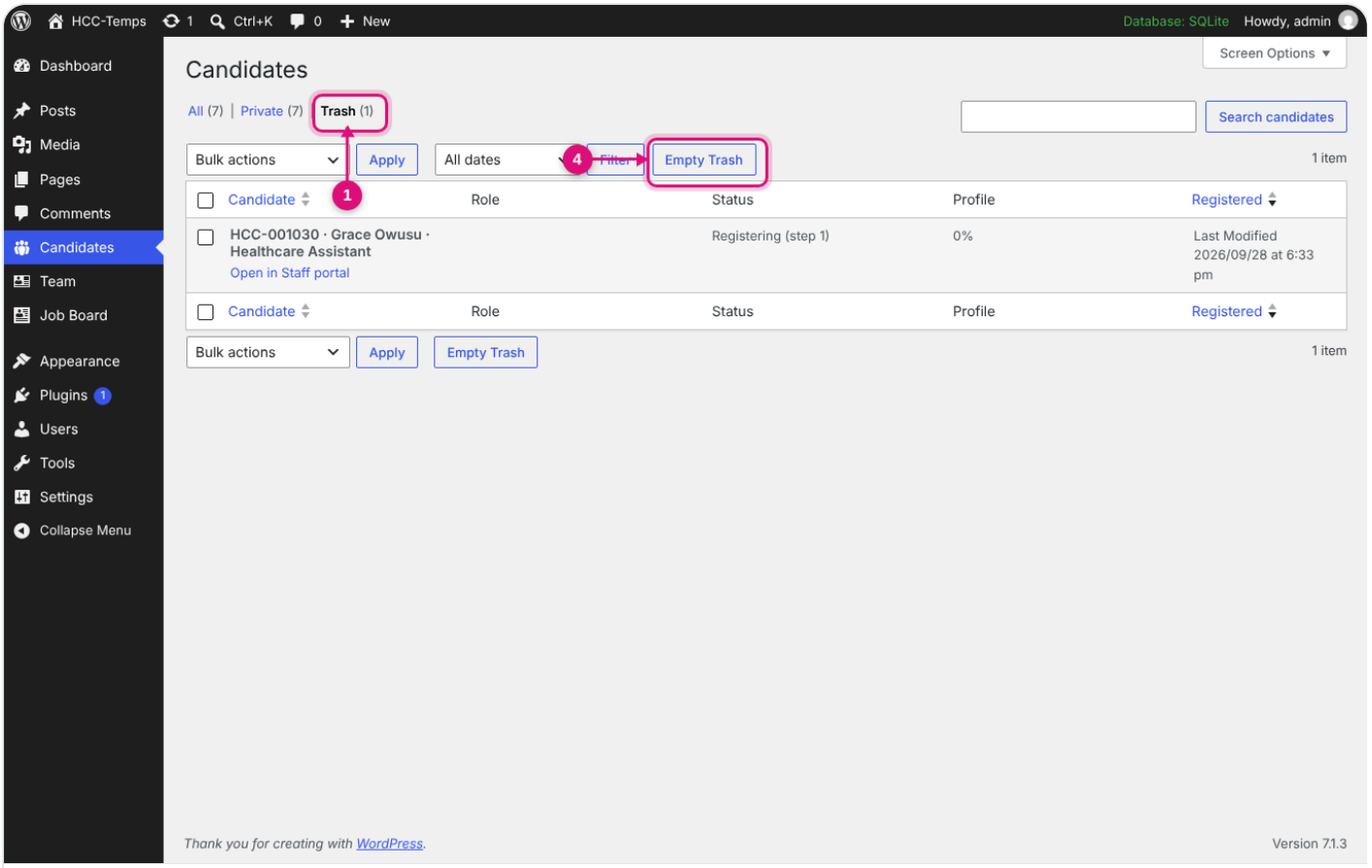
Deleting a candidate

For test registrations, duplicates, or someone who needs to start again (for example "There is already an account with this email" and they can't get in).



Candidates in the left menu.

1. Open **Candidates** in the left menu.
2. Hover over the candidate. **Open in Staff portal** takes you to their folder.
3. Press **Trash**.



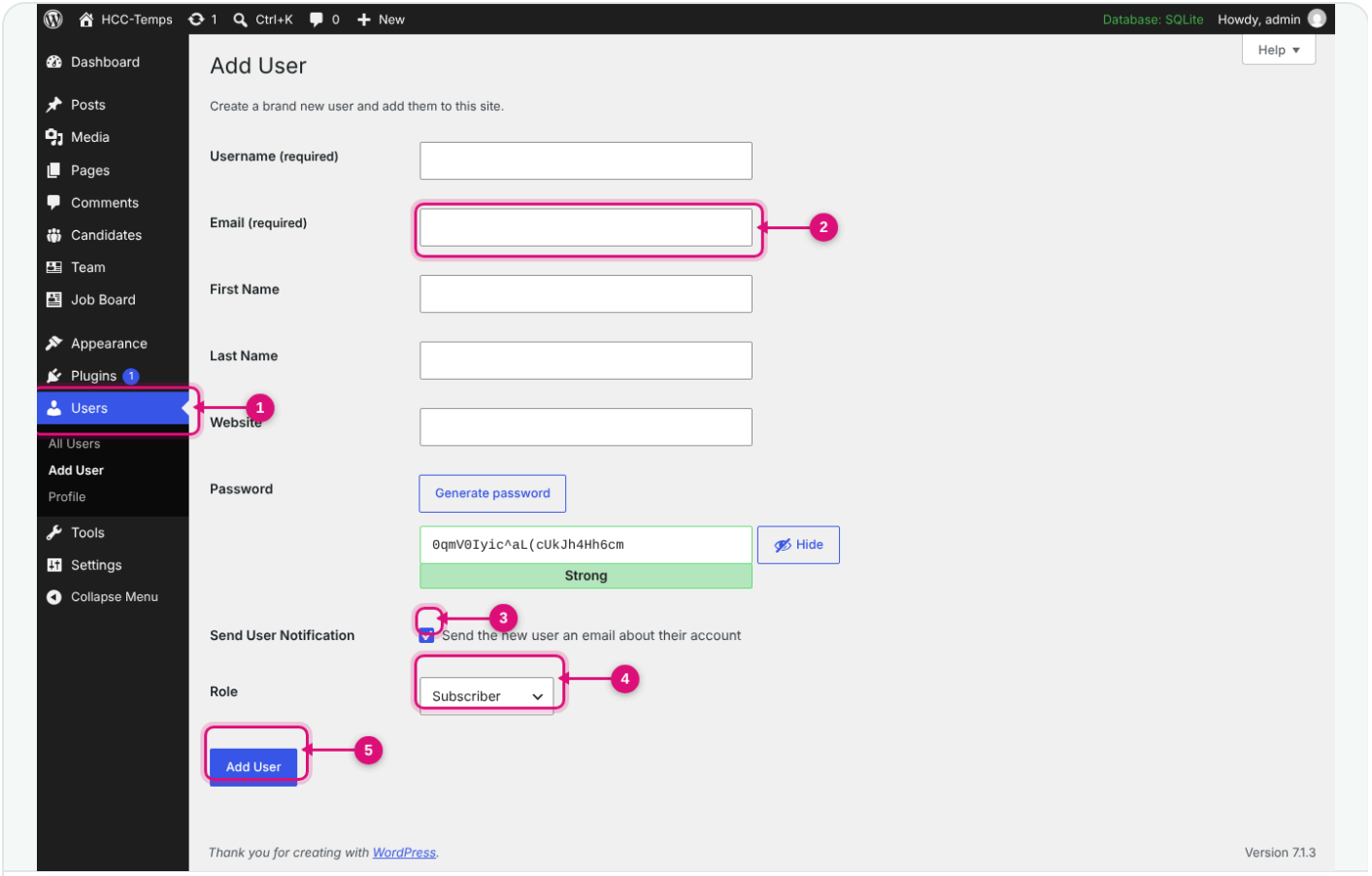
Candidates → Trash.

1. Click **Trash** at the top of the list.
2. **Restore** brings a record back if it was a mistake.
3. **Delete Permanently** removes the record, **all their uploaded files** and their login. The email can then be used to register again.
4. **Empty Trash** permanently deletes everything in the trash.

> **Trash alone is not enough**
> A candidate in the Trash still has a login, so their email still says "already registered". Permanent deletion can't be undone: download the zip first if you need to keep anything.

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Admin access and login codes



Users → Add New User.

1. **Users → Add New User**.
2. Username and email (use their work email for both).
3. Tick **Send the new user an email about their account** so they can set a password.
4. Choose the **Role**: **Administrator** (everything), **HCC Manager** or **HCC Staff** (Staff portal only).
5. Press **Add New User**.

Login codes (two-step verification)

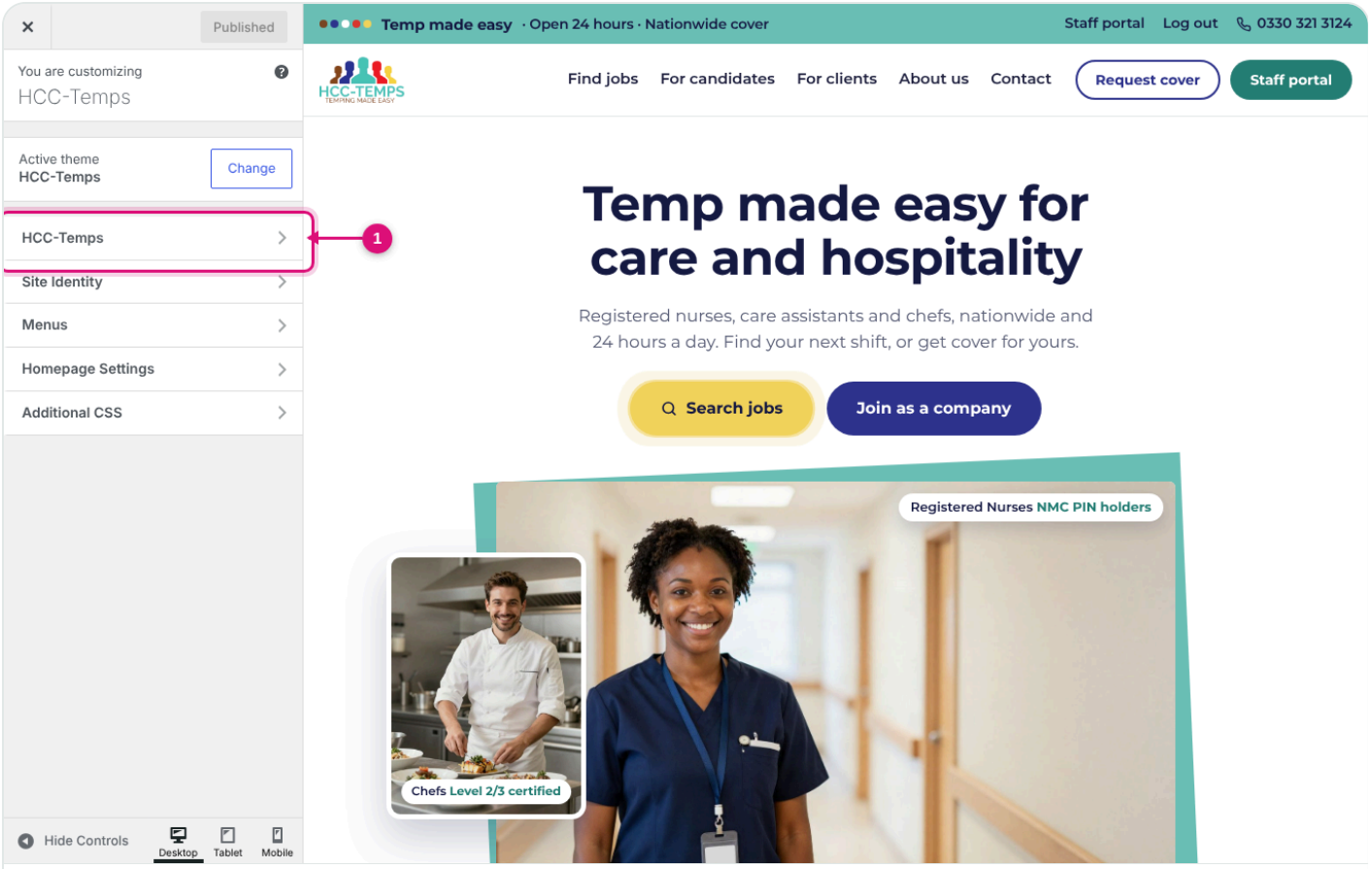
- HCC Staff, HCC Managers and candidates always get a 6-digit code by email at login. This needs the free **Two Factor** plugin to be active (Plugins menu). If it's switched off, a red notice appears in the dashboard.
- Administrators can turn the same code on for themselves: `Users → Profile → Two-Factor Options → Email`.

Removing someone's access

`Users → All Users`, hover over the person, then **Delete** (WordPress asks what to do with any content they wrote; choose to give it to another administrator). To change someone's level, edit the user and change **Role**.

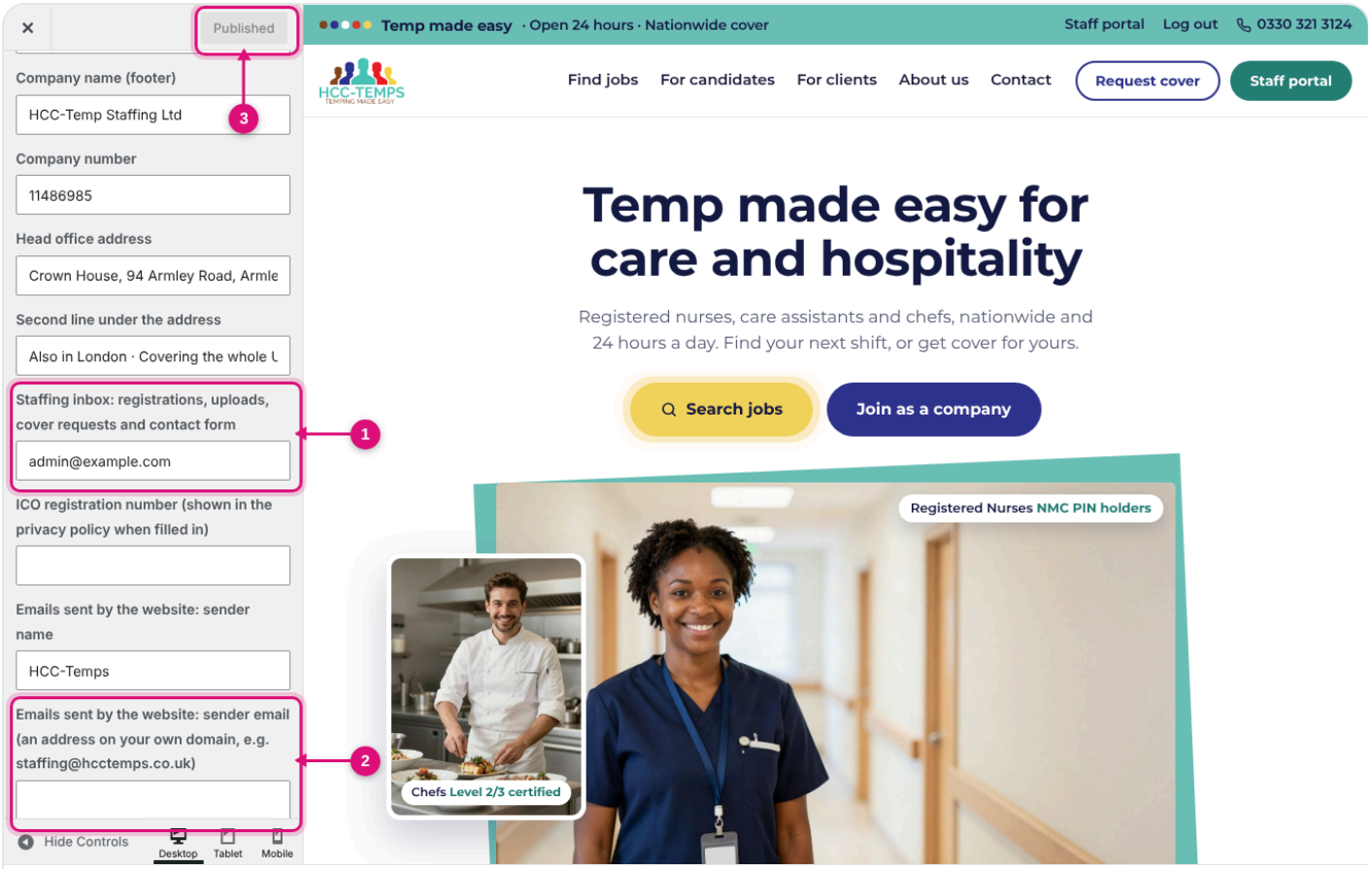
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Website settings (Customize)



Appearance → Customize.

1 Open the **HCC-Temps** panel.



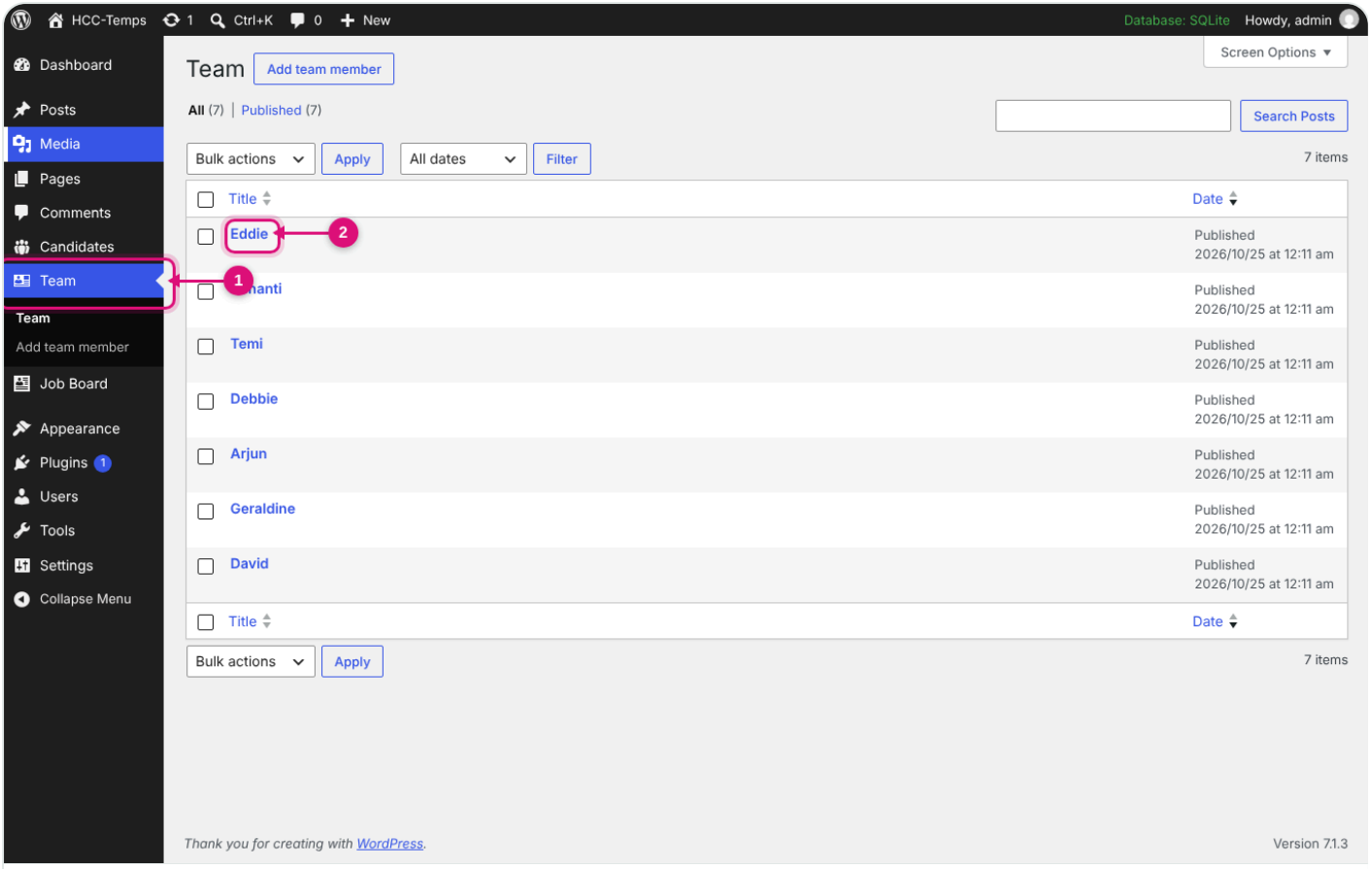
HCC-Temps → Contact details and emails.

1. **Staffing inbox**: where registrations, uploads, cover requests and contact messages go. Candidates' replies also go here.
2. **Sender name and email**: who website emails come from, e.g. "HCC-Temps" and staffing@hcctemps.co.uk.
3. Press **Publish** to save.

Section	Settings
Contact details and emails	Slogan, phone, public email, company name and number, addresses, staffing inbox, ICO number (shown in the privacy policy), sender name and email, Google Analytics ID.
Homepage	Hero heading and text, the four figures, Trustpilot link, home care (HCC Care & Support) link.
Social links	X, LinkedIn, Instagram, Facebook.
Robot check	Cloudflare Turnstile keys (optional). Without them, a simple "I'm not a robot" tick is used.

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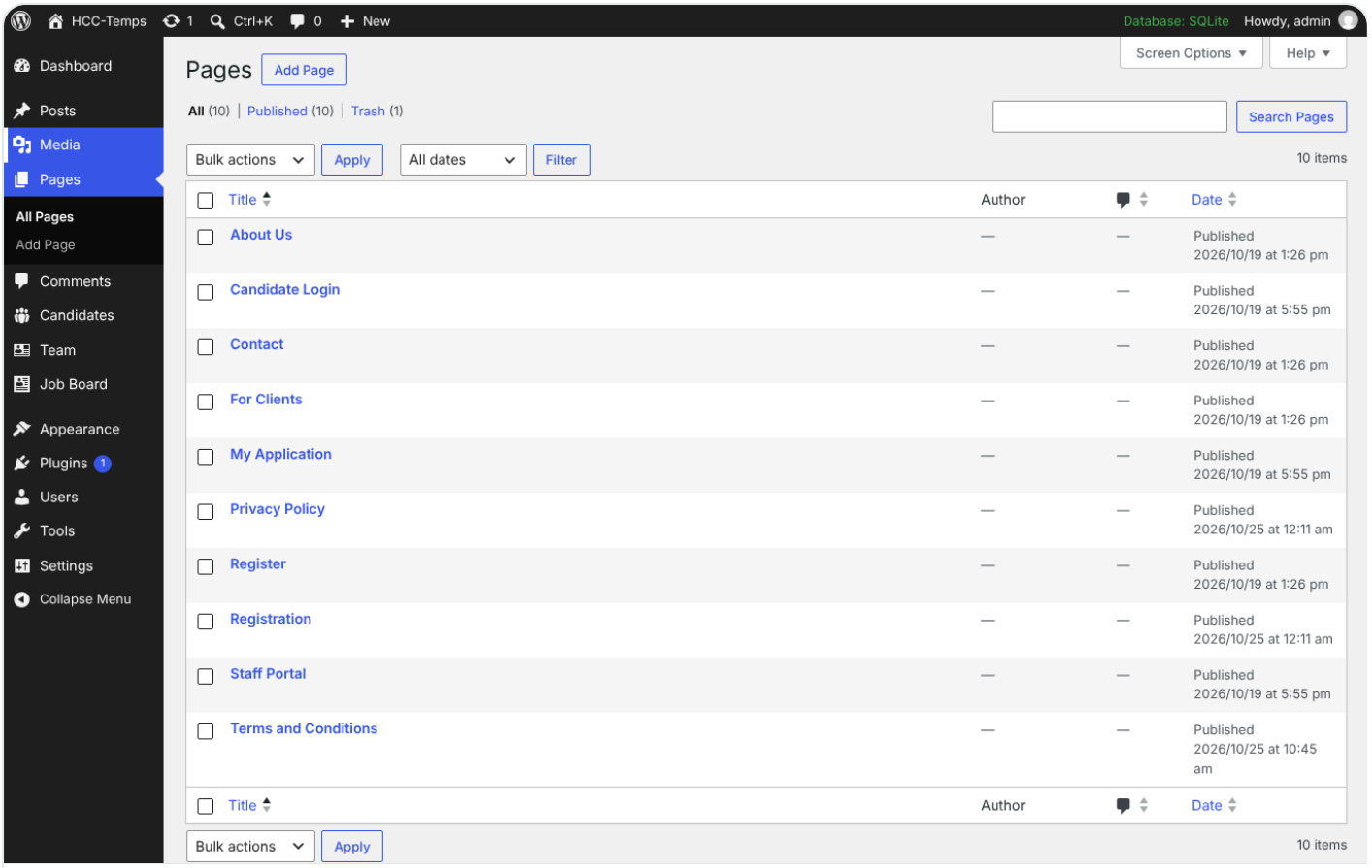
Team members on About us



Team in the left menu.

1. Open **Team**. Use **Add New** at the top for someone new.
2. Click a name to change it. The title is their first name. Fill in **Role** (e.g. Compliance Manager), set the **Photo** on the right, and use **Order** (Page attributes) for their position: 1 shows first. Press **Update**.

To remove someone, press **Trash** under their name.



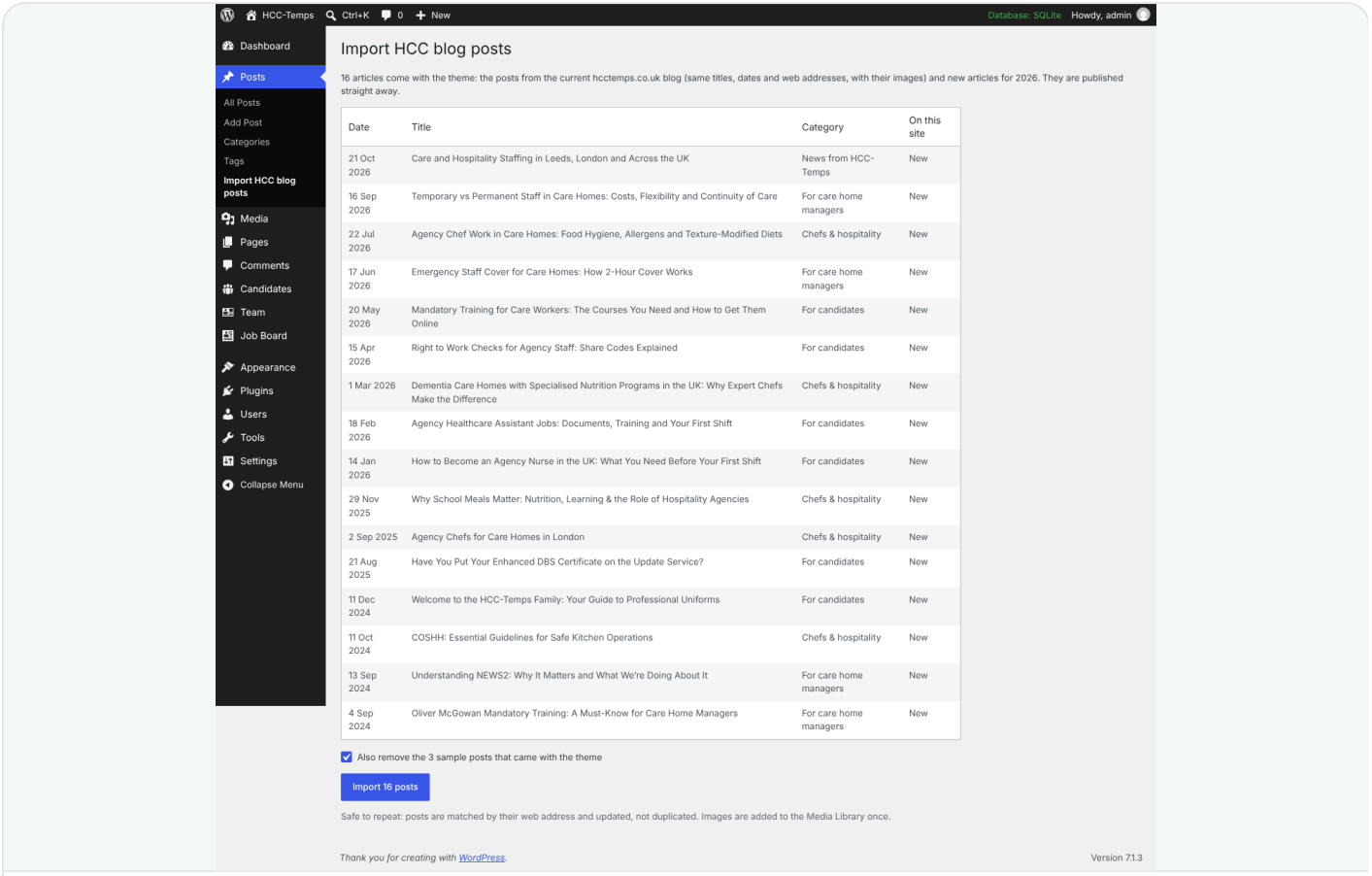
Pages: the website pages. Their layout and wording come from the theme. Ask your web developer to change the wording on Privacy Policy and Terms.

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Blog posts

Importing the HCC articles

The theme comes with 16 articles: the 8 posts from the current hcctemps.co.uk blog (same titles, dates and web addresses, so existing links keep working) and 8 new articles for 2026. Import them once at **Posts → Import HCC blog posts**:



Posts → Import HCC blog posts.

- Leave **Also remove the sample posts** ticked, then press **Import 16 posts**. The posts are published straight away, with their images in the Media Library.
- It's safe to press again: posts are updated, not duplicated.

Writing a new post

1. **Posts → Add New Post**. Type the title and the article.
2. On the right, choose a **Category** (For candidates, For care home managers, Chefs & hospitality, News from HCC-Temps) and set a **Featured image**.

3. Fill in the **Excerpt** (one or two sentences, up to about 155 characters). This is the description Google shows in search results and the summary on the blog page.
4. Press **Publish**.

> **Search engines**
> The site adds the Google description, sharing previews (for WhatsApp, Facebook and LinkedIn) and article details automatically, so no SEO plugin is needed. Private pages (portals, login, registration) are kept out of Google.

REFERENCE

Automatic emails and reminders

Email	Goes to	When
Your HCC-Temps code	Candidate	When they create an account (or change email while registering).
Welcome	Candidate	After they confirm their email.
Your registration is nearly done	Candidate	**Automatic reminders** if they haven't submitted: 24 hours and 3 days after registering.
We have your registration	Candidate	When they submit.
[REGISTRATION] full summary + CV	Staffing inbox	When they submit.
[DOCUMENTS] uploaded…	Staffing inbox	After they upload in the portal: 10 minutes after their last upload, or straight away when they press "I've finished uploading".
Update on your registration	Candidate	Only when staff press **Send email** in the update tray.
You're ready to work	Candidate	When staff press Finish onboarding.
[MESSAGE] candidate message	Staffing inbox	When a candidate writes from the Messages section of their portal.
Action needed: training certificates	Candidate	When staff send training reminders from the Training page (training reminders for one candidate go in the normal update email).
Email changed notices	Old (and new) address	When an email is changed in the portal or by staff.
[COVER REQUEST] / [CONTACT]	Staffing inbox, and a copy to the sender	From the Request cover and Contact forms.
Your HCC-Temps login code	Whoever is logging in	Every login (candidates and staff).

"Updates not sent" is your reminder

There is no automatic reminder for staff. The dashboard's **Updates not sent** box shows every candidate with unsent changes and how long they've waited (in red after a day).

REFERENCE

Troubleshooting

A candidate typed the wrong email when registering

On the "Check your email" step they press **Wrong email address? Change it** and a new code goes to the right address. If they've closed the page, change it for them in their folder (Changing a candidate's email), then they log in with the new email.

A candidate says the code didn't arrive, or "That code isn't right"

- Check spam or junk.
- Use **send a new code**. Wait 30 seconds between requests, and only the newest code works.
- After 5 wrong tries the code locks; sending a new code unlocks it.
- The activity log in their folder shows each code sent and why one was refused.

"There is already an account with this email"

They already registered. They should use **Log in**, or **Forgotten your password?** (both links appear under the message). If they need to start again from scratch, delete the old record permanently (Deleting a candidate).

Someone forgot their password

On the login page, **Forgotten your password?**, then enter their email. They get a reset link. This works for candidates and staff.

A staff member isn't getting the login code

Check spam. Check the Two Factor plugin is active (Plugins). Check their email in `Users` is right. They can press **Resend Code**.

"Too many attempts. Please wait a while or call us."

The website limits repeated form attempts from one internet connection to stop spam. It clears by itself within an hour.

An upload fails

Files must be PDF, JPG, PNG, HEIC or Word, up to 10MB. Phone photos are made smaller automatically. If a candidate has been away a long time, ask them to log in again.

A candidate's portal or a page looks out of date

Ask them to refresh the page. After a website update, clear the WordPress.com cache once (WordPress.com dashboard → Settings → Caching → Clear all caches).

Emails aren't arriving in the staffing inbox

Check **Staffing inbox** in `Appearance → Customize → HCC-Temps → Contact details and emails`, and check spam. If emails go to spam, the domain's email settings (SPF and DKIM) may need to be set up by whoever manages the domain.

I approved or finished something by mistake

- **An approval:** use ⋯ → **Ask candidate to replace**, or remove the line from the update tray before sending.
- **Finish onboarding: Move back to in progress**.
- **A closed application: Reopen application**.

Everything you do is in the activity log.

"Possible duplicate"

Another record has the same NI number or phone. Open it to check. If it's the same person, close or delete the extra one. If not, press **Checked: not a duplicate**.